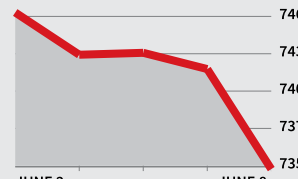


SENSEX 73524.26 (-719.08)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23123.00	-243.70
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.90	-0.19
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.70	+0.76
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	150882.00	-2738
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	244300.00	-12608

FUNDS RETREAT.

Physically-backed gold ETFs recorded outflows last week, extending negative net inflow streak to 4th week, says WGC **p8**



JUMPING SHIP.

20 TMC MPs join the NDA even as Mamata huddles with INDIA bloc to protest against govt **p9**

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QUICKLY.

AS AIFS, MFS EXPAND...
ARCs push for regulatory rejig, SARFAESI recast



Mumbai: Asset reconstruction companies (ARCs) have urged the Finance Ministry to set up a working group to review their regulatory framework and expand their role amid the growing presence of private credit funds and mutual funds in the debt market. The Association of ARCs has sought amendments to the SARFAESI Act, 2002, which was framed when banks and FIs dominated lending. ARCs want AIFs and mutual funds to be brought within the framework. **p7**

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EV stocks dip to single digit as demand surges on pricey fuel

USER SHIFT. Wait period emerging for premium electric vehicles as buyers avoid fuel guzzlers

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

A sharp surge in EV demand has pushed dealer inventory levels down to single-digit days, raising the possibility of waiting periods for select premium variants of popular models such as the MG Windsor EV, Tata Nexon EV and Mahindra BE 6.

Rising fuel prices are accelerating consumer preference for electric and CNG vehicles as also smaller fuel-efficient cars.

A similar trend is emerging in the electric two-wheeler segment, where top-end variants of Bajaj Chetak and Ather's 450X and Rizta scooters are beginning to see waiting periods. Dealers said EV makers have largely withdrawn discounts as demand gathers pace.

LARGE PVS GO SLOW

Dealers and automakers said the shift is simultaneously leading to higher inventories of larger petrol and diesel vehicles as buyers increasingly move away from fuel guzzlers, creating a sharp divide in the automobile mar-



STOCK CRUNCH. Dealers said premium trims, longer-range versions and specific colour options are seeing tighter inventory levels

ket. Former FADA President and Automotive Skills Development Council (ASDC) Chairman Vinkesh Gulati told *businessline* that EV inventory levels across both passenger vehicles and electric two-wheelers had fallen to low single-digit days and could soon translate into longer wait periods if demand continues to strengthen.

While most mainstream EV variants remain readily available, dealers said premium trims, longer-range versions and specific colour options are seeing tighter inventory levels.

The MG Windsor EV, in particular, has emerged as one of the most sought-after vehicles, especially in tier-2 and -3 markets.

"The increased demand has led to faster liquidation of dealer inventory, with most dealers reporting EV stock levels of less than the suggested norm of 30 days," a JSW MG Motor spokesperson said.

The company added that it is increasing manufacturing shifts, optimising resources and working more closely with suppliers to ease supply pressures.

The demand surge is also becoming visible at the OEM level. Tata Passenger Electric Mobility Managing Director Shailesh Chandra said during the launch of the new Tiago EV that bookings were rising sharply across the company's EV portfolio, with the key bottleneck shifting to supplier capac-

ities rather than vehicle assembly.

REGISTRATIONS UP

According to Vahan data, EV penetration in the passenger vehicle segment rose to 6.63 per cent in May from 4.51 per cent a year earlier, while CNG vehicle penetration increased to 23.34 per cent from 19.93 per cent.

FADA President CS Vigneshwar said the industry was witnessing a clear change in the fuel mix as consumers gravitated towards fuel-efficient vehicles, following the recent fuel price hikes. FADA also flagged a "small-car revival" alongside sustained SUV demand, indicating that affordability and running costs are beginning to reshape buying patterns.

Current account turns into a surplus in Q4 on jump in remittances, higher foreign direct investments

Our Bureau
Mumbai

India's current account unexpectedly swung into a surplus of 0.7 per cent of GDP in the fourth quarter (Q4FY26) from a deficit of 1.3 per cent in Q3, driven by a sharp rise in inward remittances and higher net foreign direct investments (FDI).

The current account reflects financial transactions of a country with the rest of the world, including trade, investments and transfers. A surplus on this account indicates that inflows exceed outflows, and vice-versa.

However, the Q4 current account surplus was lower than the 1.4 per cent surplus recorded in the year-ago quarter. In absolute terms, the current account posted a surplus of \$7.1 billion, compared with a deficit of \$13.2

billion in Q3FY26 and a surplus of \$13.7 billion in Q4FY25. In FY26, India's current account deficit stood at \$25.2 billion (0.6 per cent of GDP) compared with \$22.9 billion (0.6 per cent of GDP) in FY25.

PRECAUTIONARY MOVE

Gaura Sengupta, Chief Economist at IDFC First Bank, observed that the positive surprise on the current account was largely driven by remittances, with the West Asia crisis prompting precautionary transfer of funds. The trade deficit also remained range-bound as crude oil import volumes declined in March.

"We had expected the balance of payments to turn marginally positive in Q4. For FY27, we maintain our forecast of a current account deficit at 2.4 per cent of GDP, assuming an Indian crude

Major items of India's balance of payments

(in \$ billion)	Q4FY25	Q4FY26
	NET	NET
A. Current Account	13.7	7.1
1. Goods	-59.3	-83.4
2. Services	53.3	60.4
3. Primary Income	-11.9	-11.1
4. Secondary Income	31.5	41.3
B. Capital Account and Financial Account	-14.4	-8.4
1. Direct Investment	0.4	4.2
2. Portfolio Investment	-5.9	-12
3. Other Investments	7.4	16.2
4. Reserve Assets	-8.8	-7.2
C. Errors & Omissions (-) (A+B)	0.8	1.3

basket of \$90 per barrel. Capital inflow measures by the RBI and the government will support the capital account, keeping the overall balance of payments broadly stable," she said.

Personal transfer receipts, mainly representing remittances from Indians employed overseas, rose to \$43.5 billion in Q4 from

\$36.9 billion in Q3 and \$33.9 billion in Q4FY25.

POSITIVE FDI FLOWS

Net FDI inflows stood at \$4.2 billion in Q4 compared with a net outflow of \$0.2 billion in Q3. The latest quarter's inflow was also significantly higher than \$0.4 billion in Q4FY25. The merchandise trade deficit widened to

\$83.4 billion in Q4FY26 from \$59.3 billion a year earlier, while net services receipts increased to \$60.4 billion from \$53.3 billion. Net outgo under the primary income account, which mainly reflects investment income payments, declined to \$11.1 billion from \$11.9 billion.

Rahul Agrawal, Senior Economist, ICRA, said the unexpected current account surplus was largely driven by a 31 per cent year-on-year surge in the remittance inflows to a record high \$41.3 billion in the quarter, which also exceeded the Q3 levels by a healthy 17.5 per cent.

Agrawal said that while recent measures by the government and the RBI to attract capital flows are expected to provide some relief, they may not be sufficient unless net FDI inflows improve materially from the current levels.

In relief for Vodafone Idea and Bharti Airtel, Bombay HC quashes one-time retrospective spectrum charges

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

The Bombay High Court on Monday set aside the Centre's decision to levy a one-time spectrum charge retrospectively on telecom operators for spectrum held beyond 6.2 MHz between 2008 and 2012, providing major relief to Bharti Airtel and Vodafone Idea.

The court said the Centre had failed to justify any authoritative power in levying the charges and altering the financial terms of the telecom licences as an afterthought.

"We have come to a conclusion that the [telcos] have been able to make out a case in their favour seeking quashing and setting aside of the impugned decisions and consequent demand notices.

The respondent has not been able to justify the said decisions and its action of levying one-time spectrum charge retrospectively upon the petitioners," said the judgment, accessed by *businessline*.

A Division Bench of Justices Shreeram V Shirsat and Manish Pitale directed the government to set aside the demand notices and return any bank guarantees furnished by the telcos.

NO LEVY POWER

It upheld Bharti Airtel's and Vodafone Idea's arguments that the Centre holds no power to retrospectively impose a one-time spectrum charge in 2012 for spectrum held above 6.2 MHz from the year 2008 onwards.

It acknowledged that no provision under the Telegraph Act, 1885, and the li-

The Bench directed the government to return bank guarantees furnished by the telecom operators

cence agreements for allocation and use of spectrum allowed the government to do so.

Reacting to the ruling, an Airtel spokesperson said, "This ruling marks an important milestone for India's telecom sector by eliminating legal and financial uncertainty and creating a more supportive environment for future investments."

Commenting on the development, Mahesh Uppal, Director at Com First (India), said the judgment cor-

rects an arbitrary DoT decision to recover notional revenue loss due to changing spectrum value. "The DoT tried to project the price discovered in later auctions on prices set by it and paid by licensed operators previously. There was a problem with the methodology as well as the process," he said.

LONG-DRAWN BATTLE

The dispute arose from 1999 when the government announced the National Telecom Policy (NTP-99).

Upon realising that the revenue from the cellular mobile network rollout fell short of the projections, it revised the basis of payment of licence fee on a revenue-sharing model under the NTP-99. The Bench ruled that while the NTP ruled at ensuring network coverage everywhere and efficient

utilisation of spectrum, "revenue maximisation was clearly not an objective or target of NTP-99." Further, it said the government failed to change the terms of contract beforehand and disallowed the Centre from changing goalpost midway. In 2013, the High Court rejected these pleas on grounds of maintainability. In the latest ruling, the court dismissed this rationale highlighting the decade-long pendency of the issue.

"Considering the long pendency of these petitions, and the specific issues raised on behalf of the rival parties, we do not find any substance in the contention raised on behalf of the respondent that the writ petitions ought not to be entertained and that the petitioners ought to be relegated to the alternative remedy," said the court.

PM Ujjwala refills cut to 4 from 9 as OMCs' LPG losses, subsidy soar

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Union government has reduced the number of subsidised LPG refills available to Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY) beneficiaries from nine to four a year, while retaining the subsidy at ₹300 per 14.2-kg domestic cylinder.

The move follows the West Asia conflict, which has severely disrupted LPG supplies through the Strait of Hormuz, driving up benchmark Saudi CP prices.

As a result, the market price of a domestic LPG cylinder has crossed ₹1,600, while the losses of public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) have risen to around ₹700 per cylinder.

Praveen Mal Khanooja, Additional Secretary, Min-

istry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, said on Monday that PMUY households will receive a subsidy of ₹300 per cylinder on the first four refills every year, translating into an annual benefit of ₹1,200 per beneficiary.

SUBSIDY CAP

To encourage sustained LPG usage among low-income households, the government introduced a subsidy of ₹200 per 14.2-kg cylinder for up to 12 refills annually in May 2022. The subsidy was raised to ₹300 per cylinder in October 2023, while retaining the 12-refill cap. In August 2025, the cap was reduced to nine refills a year, with the subsidy remaining unchanged at ₹300 per cylinder.

Responding to questions on the reduction in subsidised refills, Khanooja said that even non-Ujjwala con-

sumers are receiving indirect support as the retail price remains significantly below the market cost.

UNDER-RECOVERIES UP

Khanooja added that OMCs' under-recoveries are currently about ₹700 per 14.2-kg cylinder, similar to earlier periods when the government compensated the companies with ₹52,000 crore across FY23 and FY24.

At present, a 14.2-kg LPG cylinder costs ₹942 for general consumers and ₹642 for PMUY beneficiaries in Delhi. The government's LPG subsidy bill is expected to rise to around ₹60,000 crore in FY26 from ₹41,338 crore in the previous year.

India has over 33.5 crore LPG-consuming households, including more than 10.5 crore PMUY beneficiaries.

QUICKLY.

Dabur sets up GCC for IT, digital marketing

New Delhi: Dabur India announced the establishment of two strategic global capability centres (GCCs). It added that the IT GCC serves as a strategic hub powering its the company's digital backbone and digital marketing GCC will be the next-gen marketing engine. Dabur India Global CEO Mohit Malhotra said: "At Dabur, we are reimagining our future through a sharp focus on digital, data and global capability building," OUR BUREAU

Immuneel raises over ₹100 cr in Series B round

Bengaluru: Cell and gene therapy start-up Immuneel Therapeutics has raised over ₹100 crore in a Series B funding round, led by new investors, including Singularity AMC and Zerodha-backed Rainmatter, as it looks to scale capacity, commercialise its CAR-T cancer therapy and expand internationally. Immuneel plans to use the fresh capital to expand its GMP capacity, OUR BUREAU

Grasim Industries to invest ₹3,094 cr to add Lyocell capacity in Karnataka

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Grasim Industries, an Aditya Birla Group company, will invest ₹3,094 crore to add 1.10 lakh tonne per annum (tpa) capacity of Lyocell at Harihar in Karnataka.

The phase-II expansion of Lyocell capacity will consist of two lines of 55,000 tpa each. The first line is expected to be commissioned by 2028 and the second by 2030. The project will be funded through a mix of debt and internal accruals. This additional capacity will complement the phase-I plant of

Auto retail sales hit all-time high in May, EV reach crosses 11% for the first time

CHANGING GEARS. Demand grows for green vehicles after last month's fuel price hikes, says FADA

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The automobile retail sales have recorded the best-ever May in overall registrations including passenger vehicles (PVs), two-wheelers (2Ws) and three-wheelers (3Ws), the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA) said on Monday.

Significantly, the electric vehicle (EV) penetration crossed 11 per cent for the first time, as dealers saw a surge in enquiries for fuel-efficient and green vehicles after last month's fuel price hikes amid the West Asia crisis, FADA noted.

"A notable feature of the month was the consumer response to May fuel-price revisions: Dealers reported a visible rise in enquiries for fuel-efficient and alternative-powertrain options, reflected in the two-wheeler EV share climbing to 9.25 per



In fast lane			
Category	May 2026	May 2025	% change
Passenger vehicles	4,02,591	3,26,656	23.25
Two wheelers	18,44,947	17,15,581	7.54
Three wheelers	1,11,526	1,07,688	3.56
Commercial vehicles	83,823	79,614	5.29
Tractors	83,092	74,744	11.17
Grand total	25,31,067	23,10,451	9.55

Source: FADA Research

cent from 6.11 per cent a year ago. Overall alternative fuel share rose to 38 per cent+ in May," CS Vigneshwar, President, FADA, said.

On the channel side, PV inventory edged up to a range of 31-33 days at May-end from 28-30 days at the close of April. Inventory is now moving away from FADA's recommended 21-day

benchmark, he said. "We urge PV original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) to maintain disciplined dispatches through the seasonally-softer June window so that channel stocks stay closely aligned with retail demand," he added.

Overall, the grand total of all vehicles across categories grew 9.55 per cent year on

year to 25,31,067 units in May as compared with 23,10,451 units in the same month last year.

SEGMENT-WISE

The PV retail sales in May grew 23.25 per cent to 4,02,591 units (3,26,656 units), FADA said in its monthly sales report.

Similarly, the 2W sales grew 7.54 per cent to 18,44,947 units (17,15,581 units). The 3W segment grew 3.56 per cent to 1,11,526 units (1,07,688 units). Commercial vehicle (CV) sales grew 5.29 per cent to 83,823 units (79,614 units).

"Above-normal heatwave, fuel-price pressure and the evolving West Asia situation did come into play during May 2026, and yet Indian auto retail has held its growth trajectory with May 2026 registering the best-ever May across 3W, PV, Tractors and overall regis-

trations," Vigneshwar said.

In June, dealer sentiment is measured, with 50.52 per cent of dealers expecting growth, 39.90 per cent anticipating a flat market and only 9.59 per cent foreseeing a decline, he noted.

He added that June appears measured but cautiously optimistic, with monsoon progress and rural cash flows expected to provide the structural support even as near-term cost pressures persist.

"With the South-West monsoon having set in over Kerala on June 4, and beginning its northward advance, demand expectations are anchored in the progress of the monsoon, early Kharif sowing preparation and the tail of the marriage season, supported by a stable financing environment after the Reserve Bank of India held the repo rate at 5.25 per cent in its June review," Vigneshwar added.

IT firms see rising share of revenue from BFSI in FY26

Rohan Das
Chennai

After a dip in FY25, four of the five top-tier Indian IT services players saw an increase in share of revenue from the BFSI vertical in FY26, according to data from the companies' annual reports. Speaking to *businessline*, experts suggest that the increase in revenue contribution from BFSI is a combination of both absolute growth driven by modernisation and AI projects while also being aided by contractions in other verticals like technology, telecom, manufacturing and retail.

In FY26, BFSI accounted for 32 per cent of TCS' overall revenue, after having

dropped to 30.9 per cent in the previous fiscal. HCLTech saw the sector's contribution to its topline rise to 21.5 per cent (20.7 per cent). In the case of Infosys, the share of revenue from BFSI saw a relatively modest growth to 28 per cent (27.7 per cent), while for Tech Mahindra it went up to 16.3 per cent (16.1 per cent). Meanwhile, Wipro bucked the trend having seen a drop to 34.1 per cent (34.3 per cent).

In absolute terms, these companies saw a 1-7.5 per cent year-on-year growth in the BFSI revenue in FY26 relative to FY25 with the exception of Wipro, which saw a degrowth of 0.7 per cent.

CORE PRODUCTIVITY
Vivek Iyer, Partner and Fin-



KEY VERTICAL. In absolute terms, these companies saw BFSI revenues go up 1-7.5 per cent GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

ancial Services Risk Leader, Grant Thornton Bharat, suggests that unlike other verticals banks and financial institutions are using AI and technology investments for core productivity gains rather than discretionary innovation spending, making the segment relatively resilient even during periods of macro stress. "In addition,

the currency depreciation is also improving the cost competitiveness of Indian IT vendors, potentially supporting outsourcing demand from global BFSI clients through FY27," he said.

Pushpa Marwal, Analyst at Forrester, believes that the trend can be attributed to underperformance in other verticals. "While BFSI share

‘Our immediate endeavour is to increase CASA ratio from around 30% to 32%’

bl.interview

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Canara Bank's new MD and CEO Brajesh Kumar Singh is betting on a younger customer base, digital banking and low-cost deposits to improve profitability, saying the lender will focus on strengthening efficiency metrics rather than chasing balance-sheet growth alone.

Edited excerpts:

What will be your key focus areas?

The bank is doing well in terms of business growth, but there is room to improve efficiency parameters. Our CASA ratio is around 30 per

cent, while some peers are at 40 per cent. Similarly, our net interest margin can improve. My first priority is on the resources side, raising low-cost deposits and improving CASA, which will strengthen overall efficiency.

Do you have a CASA target in mind?

Our immediate endeavour is to increase CASA from around 30 per cent to 32 per cent. Over the medium term, we would like to take it to about 35 per cent. The idea is to reduce dependence on bulk deposits and build a more stable retail deposit franchise.

How do you plan to attract younger customers?

The younger generation

The residual exposure of Canara Bank to Rajesh Exports is not expected to have any significant impact on the balance sheet

BRAJESH KUMAR SINGH
MD and CEO, Canara Bank



How much is Canara Bank investing in technology and digital capabilities?

Technology is already one of our largest areas of expenditure. We spend around 10 per cent of our total annual expenditure on technology, making it the second-largest

wants banking services delivered differently. They are comfortable doing everything digitally and rarely visit branches. I want Canara Bank to become the preferred bank for this generation. We need to make banking seamless, convenient and relevant to their needs.

Notification on V2V communication soon; Ministry working on it: Gadkari

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The notification on vehicle-to-vehicle (V2V) communication will come soon. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) is working on it, Minister Nitin Gadkari told *businessline* on Monday.

"We are getting the frequencies (from the Ministry of Communications) required for the V2V communications and we will soon notify. Such a technology will help reduce a lot of accidents on the roads," Gadkari said. The V2V communication allows vehicles to swap real-time safety data, serving as a vital global tool for accident prevention. The Department of Telecommunications was supposed to de-license the 5.875-5.925 GHz spectrum band, which can be used for V2V communications.

Last week, *businessline* reported that MoRTH has to

work on mandating V2V deployment in vehicles including two-wheelers, on the device and specifications for such technology to be installed in vehicles.

ROAD SAFETY

Meanwhile, speaking at the an event organised by ride-hailing platform Rapido, Gadkari said India records nearly five lakh road accidents and 1.80 lakh fatalities every year. "Road safety is a shared responsibility and citizen participation is critical to reducing fatalities on our roads...Our biggest problem is changing public behaviour and enforcing traffic laws," he noted. The number of road accident fatalities in India went up 2.3 per cent to over 1.77 lakh in 2024, resulting in the deaths of 485 persons every day.

Gadkari said that is why the MoRTH notified the Good Samaritan Rules in 2020 under Section 134A of the Motor Vehicles (Amend-

ment) Act, 2019 to support and protect those who step forward in such moments. "Through the Rah-Veer Scheme, we seek to encourage individuals to assist accident victims without hesitation and help save lives during the Golden Hour," he said.

Under the 'Rah-Veer' (Good Samaritan) scheme, anyone who helps an accident victim receive medical attention within the Golden Hour is eligible for a ₹25,000 reward and a Certificate of Appreciation, with recognition available up to five times a year for repeat acts of bravery.

Gadkari added that the Centre has also come up with a modified scheme to provide cashless treatment for road accident victims nationwide, under which a victim is entitled to a maximum amount of ₹1.5 lakh per accident for a maximum period of seven days (from the date of accident).

Haleon to invest ₹2,000 cr in first India unit for oral care products

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

In a strategic move, Haleon said it will invest about ₹2,000 crore (£175 million) to set up its first manufacturing facility in India, which is one of its fastest growing markets. The company is setting up a modern greenfield site at Pithampur, Madhya Pradesh, focused on oral care, which is expected to get operational by 2029-30. The plant will not only serve India, but also export products to other Asian markets over time.

Brian McNamara, Chief Executive Officer, Haleon, said, "This will be our largest investment in India. It will strengthen our supply chain, while reducing the reliance on imports into India. This will also allow us to respond faster to local needs, particularly in oral health, which is a business where we have seen consistent double-digit growth. It directly supports our growth strategy in India,

which is focused on innovation-led premiumisation."

The company's portfolio includes Sensodyne, Parodontax, Pronamel, Centrum, Eno, Otrivin, Iodex and Crocin. India is the second-largest market for its oral-care brand Sensodyne globally.

Kedar Lele, CEO, India, and President, Haleon ISC, added, "While this facility will make our operations self-sufficient for India, we also expect this facility to become a key part of our global manufacturing network and export to key markets in the wider Asia region."

LONG-TERM GROWTH

The investment comes at a time when India's consumer healthcare market is projected to reach over \$23 billion by 2030.

"Emerging markets represent 35 per cent of our portfolio, but drive over 50 per cent of our growth, and India is a critical contributor to that disproportionate growth. Last year, we laid out

If the right opportunity arises, we are open to invest in inorganic growth

BRIAN MCNAMARA
Chief Executive Officer, Haleon

a global ambition to reach one billion additional consumers by 2030, and India plays a key role in that, contributing 300 million of those consumers alone. It is a highly compelling long-term growth opportunity for Haleon," McNamara noted.

On the impact of the West Asia conflict on consumer sentiment, McNamara said the company's investment decisions are based on the medium- and long-term growth prospects. "In India, global oil prices haven't fully translated into higher domestic fuel prices yet. At some point that may need to happen, as the government

Tata Trusts reviews strategy ahead of Tata Sons' board meet

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Trustees of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust met on Monday in what sources described as largely a stock-taking exercise ahead of the Tata Sons board meeting on Friday.

Among the matters discussed were presentations made last month by the heads of several Tata group companies. Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata has been seeking greater clarity on the strategy for the group's loss-making businesses and the roadmap for turning them profitable. He has also sought more detailed explanations on the group's newer ventures and the rationale behind the substantial investments being made in them.

GROWING SCRUTINY

Monday's meeting took place against the backdrop of growing scrutiny over the governance of the Tata Trusts. The Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) is facing allegations of violating provisions of the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act, while an inquiry

by the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner into the composition of the Trusts' board of trustees is currently underway. An order in the matter is awaited.

In May, the Charity Commissioner's office directed the Trusts to defer a board meeting pending completion of the inquiry. The complainants have alleged that the board had appointed more permanent trustees than permitted under the law. Sources said the trustees discussed the allegations, the Charity Commissioner's directive and the Trusts' response to the issues raised.

Separately, former trustee Mehli Mistry has once again approached the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner, filing an objection to a change report submitted by the SRTT. In the filing, submitted on Friday, Mistry alleged governance lapses, conflicts of interest and breaches of fiduciary duty by certain trustees of the Tata Trusts. The objection focuses largely on commissions and remuneration allegedly received by trustees who serve as nominee directors on the boards of Tata group companies.

is going up, a part of it is being driven by other industries contracting or being flat. In such a scenario, BFSI doesn't have to do much to look stronger," he said. Marwal also said that current deals are more necessity-led backlog clearing from previous years.

AI ADOPTION

A report from Kotak Institutional Equities suggests in sectors like banking, many AI projects are moving from the pilot stage and entering production environments. The report cautioned that in the long-run AI could eventually create revenue deflation as banks report productivity gains in areas like application development and customer service leading to lower bil-

lable effort for IT service players.

In the Q4FY26 earnings call, K Krithivasan, CEO and MD, TCS, said that though increased macroeconomic uncertainty has resulted in cautious investment decision-making, BFSI clients continued to prioritise core and legacy modernisation alongside AI/GenAI investments.

On the outlook for the BFSI vertical in FY27, Gaurav Vasu, Co-founder, UnearthInsight, suggested that since most of the spending in BFSI is non-discretionary priorities, the vertical appears more resilient than most other verticals.

(With Inputs from BL Intern G. Mahalakshmi)

TCS, Canada Life sign multi-year agreement

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) has signed a multi-year agreement with Canada Life, global life and pensions insurer, to modernise its IT infrastructure services across its European businesses.

TCS will leverage its AI and digital capabilities to modernise and manage Canada Life's data centres, core infrastructure, end-user computing and software lifecycle management to build a strong foundation for Canada Life's long-term technology modernisation journey.

of these institutions and, in certain cases, acquire loan portfolios from them. The opportunity is large enough for both banks and fintechs to grow together.

Rajesh Exports has been in the spotlight following SEBI's interim order. Canara Bank has exposure to the company. How do you view the recovery prospects?

The residual exposure of Canara Bank to Rajesh Exports is meagre compared to the total credit facilities extended. The exposure is fully provided for and is recoverable. The residual exposure is not expected to have any significant impact on the bank's balance sheet or financial position.



share of therapeutic oral health, delivering double-digit growth over the last several years, driven by our main brand, Sensodyne," he noted.

Asked about inorganic growth opportunities, McNamara said, "We want to pursue inorganic growth through bolt-on acquisitions. Our priority is higher-growth categories and higher-growth markets like India. If the right opportunity arises, we are open to invest in inorganic growth. Obviously, it has to make strategic sense for the business, have a willing seller, and come at the right valuation."

businessline.

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With surge in crude volatility, OMCs incurring daily losses of ₹600-700 cr

GROWING CONCERN. West Asia conflict pushing oil prices higher and deepening losses for PSU fuel retailers

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The PSU oil marketing companies (OMCs) are facing a daily loss of around ₹600-700 crore on an industry basis due to the volatility in crude oil prices on account of the West Asian conflict, which intensified further with Iran attacking Israel on Sunday.

Pravin Mal Khanuja, Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas (MoPNG), said the under-recovery on petrol currently is ₹6 per litre and that on diesel is ₹30 a litre.

Besides, on an industry basis, PSU OMCs are losing around ₹600-700 crore per day on a cumulative basis.

“All refineries are operating at high capacity with adequate crude inventories, while sufficient stocks of petrol and diesel

are being maintained. All retail outlets are operating normally across the country,” the senior Oil Ministry official emphasised.

To manage losses, PSU OMCs have already raised petrol and diesel prices by roughly ₹7.50 a litre each in four instalments. CNG prices were also revised upwards by ₹6 per kg.

On the brighter side, about 9.16 lakh piped natural gas (PNG) connections have been operationalised since March 1 and infrastructure has been created for additional 3.05 lakh connections, taking the total to 12.21 lakh connections, Khanuja said.

Besides, about 9.24 lakh customers have been registered for new connections.

Further, 82,000 PNG consumers have surrendered their LPG connections till June 7.

Refineries supplied 2,760 tonnes of C3/C4 molecules and



MANAGING LOSSES. OMCs have already raised petrol and diesel prices by roughly ₹7.50 a litre each in four instalments PTI

1,660 tonnes of butyl electrolyte since June 1 for chemicals and pharma, he added. Despite the ongoing situation in West Asia, supplies of crude oil, LPG and natural gas remain stable. India has adequate stocks of petrol, diesel and LPG available in the country, he assured.

LPG PRODUCTION
Khanuja said that domestic LPG production has been maximised with domestic refineries

and fractionators continuing to produce about 52-53 thousand tonnes per day (TPD), about 60 per cent higher than pre-crisis levels.

“There have been no reports of dry-out at LPG distributorships. LPG delivery backlogs have been reduced to less than four days, while 99 per cent of LPG cylinder bookings are now made online. The Delivery Authentication Code (DAC) compliance rate stands at around 96

per cent” he added. It is expected that OMC losses may increase further after Iran’s attack on Israel on Sunday, which has again pushed up crude oil prices. On Monday, Brent stood at \$94.78 a barrel and WTI was trading at \$91.88 per barrel.

Norbert Rucker, Head, Economics and Next Generation Research at Julius Baer, said the hot-headed politics in West Asia keeps the oil market nervous. With the latest exchange of hostilities between Israel and Iran, the broader conflict’s power balance and resolution are once again on the testbed.

“Diplomacy remains in gridlock and could falter, not least given the latest events and the challenges they bring to the US-Israel alliance. That said, a full-scale escalation has remained absent so far, and looking ahead, these chances incrementally diminish over time,” he added.

India, MERCOSUR target expanded preferential trade pact by mid-2027

Our Bureau
New Delhi

In a boost to Indian exporters aiming to diversify more prominently into Latin America, India and the four-member MERCOSUR trading bloc are set to finalise the terms of reference (ToR) for expanding their existing preferential trade agreement (PTA) within the next two months, senior officials said.

India’s expanded PTA with the MERCOSUR — including South American economic heavyweights Argentina and Brazil, alongside Paraguay and Uruguay — is likely to be in place by mid-2027, under a strictly fast-tracked negotiating timeline, said Vimal Anand, Joint Secretary, Department of Commerce, at an event organised by EEPIC India in Panaji,

CLOSER TO PACT

- Terms of reference for negotiations to be finalised in two months
- Deal may be wrapped up within a year
- India and the MERCOSUR bloc are looking at expanding the list to 1,500-3000 items

Goa, on Monday. “We already have a PTA with MERCOSUR, but it has only 450 lines. We have recently embarked on an exercise to expand the PTA. Currently, we are negotiating on the terms of reference for deciding the modalities of the negotiations, which will be concluded in a couple of months,” Anand said.

TRADE EXPANSION
The expansion of the India-

MERCOSUR trade pact is also important as New Delhi navigates a highly volatile global trade environment, and is facing an unpredictable tariff situation in the US, its largest export market.

Under the India-MERCOSUR PTA, operationalised in 2009, the two sides offer tariff concessions to each other, ranging from 10 per cent to 100 per cent, on 450 and 452 tariff lines, respectively.

India and the MERCOSUR bloc are looking at expanding the list to about 1,500-3000 items with India’s interest in greater market access for items such as engineering goods, automobiles, pharmaceuticals and electronics, an industry source said.

“Although there is a big demand for engineering goods Brazil and Argentina, the import duties are very high, touching 40-50 per cent for certain items. If import duties are reduced once the PTA is expanded, exports will go up substantially,” an exporter present at the event remarked. Oil, gas and critical minerals available in abundance in Latin America is an additional draw for India, the source added. India’s exports to Latin America in FY 2025 was at \$15.17 billion, which is less than 2 per cent of the region’s total

imports, indicating a lot of potential for growth.

Anand said that India’s FTAs with key partners, including the United Kingdom, European Union, United Arab Emirates, Australia and EFTA countries, are creating new opportunities for Indian exporters by reducing trade barriers and improving competitiveness.

CORRIGENDUM

With reference to the L&T AGM advertisement published on 6 June 2026, it is clarified that, in the Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft programme, L&T executed its scope in a contracted role for Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), which is the design authority for the project.

We regret any unintended ambiguity and confusion caused.

Larsen & Toubro Limited

Rupee records biggest single day fall in a month, closes at 95.71/\$

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The rupee on Monday almost ceded all the gains it made in the last trading session, recording its biggest single day fall in a month in the process.

The Indian currency was weighed down by high crude oil prices amid the continuing West Asia conflict, dollar gaining strength and expectation of the US Fed tightening monetary policy in the coming months.

The rupee closed at 95.71 per US dollar, down 0.81 per cent, against the previous close of 94.94. It got a booster shot last Friday as the RBI announced crucial measures to attract

foreign capital via Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposits, overseas borrowings, government securities, and equity investments.

These measures buoyed the rupee, which posted its biggest single-day gain since April 2. It perked up 84 paise to close at 94.94/dollar against the previous close of 95.89.

Amit Pabari, MD, CR Forex Advisors, observed that the RBI’s measures should not be viewed only through the lens of today’s market conditions.

“By taking these measures now, the central bank has laid the groundwork for attracting foreign capital when global risk appetite improves,” he said.



Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd
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TAMILNAD MERCANTILE BANK LIMITED
CIN: L65110TN1921PLC001908
Regd. office: 57, V. E. Road, Thoothukudi – 628 002
Phone: 0461-2321932 (E), 2321929 (E)
Website: www.tmb.bank.in | e-mail: shareholders@tmbank.in

Notice to Shareholders

Launch of “Saksham Niveshak” Campaign

Pursuant to the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (IEPFA), letter dated March 27, 2026, Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd (“the Bank”) has initiated the second 100 days’ campaign titled “**Saksham Niveshak**”, starting from **1st April, 2026 to 9th July, 2026**. This campaign has been launched to encourage shareholders to **claim the unpaid / undclaimed dividends and to update their KYC details** (Bank account mandate, Signature, PAN, Nominee Registration, Contact information (email, mobile number, address)) with the Bank’s Registrar and Transfer Agent (R&T), i.e. MUFG Intime India Private Limited and to prevent such dividends from being transferred to the IEPF.

Shareholders who have not claimed their dividends or have not updated their KYC details or submitted the incomplete KYC details are requested to contact the Bank / our Registrar and Transfer Agent (RTA) at the address mentioned below.

Additionally, shareholders are encouraged to register and track their requests through the SWAYAM portal: <https://swayam.in.mpms.mufg.com> / register a service request in the following link https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/helpdesk/Service_Request.html

Special Window for Transfer and De-materialisation of Physical Shares

Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-P0D/13750/2026 dated **January 30, 2026**, shareholders are hereby informed that another **Special Window** has been opened for a period of **one (1) year, from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027**, for the **re-lodgement of transfer requests for physical share certificates**.

This facility is applicable to **transfer deeds lodged prior to April 1, 2019** and which were **rejected, returned, or not attended** due to **deficiencies in documents, process, or otherwise** and also for **transfer deeds executed before April 01, 2019 but not lodged with the Bank**.

Shareholders are encouraged to take advantage of this opportunity by submitting the requisite documents to the Bank / our Registrar and Transfer Agent (RTA) at the address mentioned below:

Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Limited Secretarial Section, Regd. office: 57, V. E. Road, Thoothukudi – 628 002. Phone: 0461-2321932 (E), 2321929 (E) Website: www.tmb.bank.in e-mail: shareholders@tmbank.in	MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Unit: Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Limited) Surya 35, Mayflower Avenue, Behind Senthil Nagar, Sowripalayam Road, Coimbatore – 641 028. T: +91 422 2314792, 2539835 / 836, 4958995 e-mail: investor.helpdesk@in.mpms.mufg.com
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For Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Limited
Sd/-
Swapnil Velgaonkar
Company Secretary
(Membership no: ACS 21877)

Place: Thoothukudi
Date: June 08, 2026

AT THIS MOMENT,
THE **WORLD'S EVOLVING.**
AND SO IS **ENERGY.**

In a future of limitless opportunity, energy is not just a resource. It is the very foundation of human possibility. Our energy choices today will define how far we go and how much we achieve in an energy-hungry future.

That’s why we are advancing the future of all renewable energy technologies that work.

GOOD ENERGIES THAT WORK

SUZLON

Wind first, full-stack renewable energy solutions

WIND

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RE PROJECTS

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A CH-CHE

Mind the gap

Rising C-D ratio needs to be closely watched

On Monday, the Reserve Bank of India issued draft directions, inviting public comments, on transparency regarding bank interest rates. A major feature in this regard is the provision that interest rate applicable on deposits will be strictly “as per the schedule of interest rates disclosed on the bank website”. The context is not hard to seek.



Recently, the country’s largest private bank allegedly paid a higher interest rate on deposits to a public sector unit than its stated norm, concealing the payout through its marketing channels. At last week’s monetary policy press conference, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said “competition (for deposits) is healthy as long as it is fair and transparent”. The policy draft seems in line with this assertion. This episode is not unrelated to a larger development in banking — a rising credit-deposit ratio that is pushing banks to raise bulk deposits. With the growth in deposits not keeping up with that of credit, the credit-deposit ratio has moved to 81.4 towards the end of March 2026, and rising. The C-D ratio is above the recommended range of 65-80. While public sector banks have a C-D ratio well below 80, private banks’ ratios are well above 90.

To be sure, there are no indications of systemic risk as of now, as private banks maintain a liquidity coverage ratio of over 100. But the question is whether this should be seen as indicative of aggressive lending, deposit-seeking, or smart treasury management. The rising C-D is driven by high credit growth, rather than low deposit growth. The former, which had turned sluggish in FY25, recorded a strong growth of 16.1 per cent, taking outstanding credit to ₹213.6 lakh crore by the end of March 2026. The increase in credit demand has been led by loans to MSMEs and retail loans such as vehicle loans, gold loans and loans against fixed deposits. Banks have managed to grow their deposits in this period, though at a lower 13.5 per cent, thanks also to stock markets entering a correction phase. Banks also have to contend with the fact that high interest-bearing time deposits account for 85 per cent of aggregate deposits, while the cheaper demand deposits have a smaller 15 per cent share, increasing the payouts for banks.

With banks lending long in the absence of an infra lending window, there appears to be much competition for the wholesale deposits which carry higher rates of interest. RBI’s data show that the weighted average term deposit rate has declined 55 basis points for fresh deposits and 47 basis points on outstanding deposits in the current rate cutting cycle of 125 basis points between February 2025 and March 2026. If bank deposits have to be competitive with other asset classes, banks also have to be ready to increase deposit rates. If the C-D ratio increases, banks may resort to short-term market borrowings, which beyond a point could lead to asset-liability mismatch. In this scenario, the RBI should keep an eye out on sharp practices in garnering deposits or pushing credit.



Monetary implications of RBI’s surplus transfer

POSITIVE EFFECT. Once the surplus is transferred to government and it spends the same, it results in injection of durable liquidity



C RANGARAJAN
RK PATTNAIK

During fiscal 2025-26 RBI transferred to Central government a surplus of ₹2,86,588.46 crore (0.83 per cent of GDP) on the top of a surplus transfer of ₹2,68,590.07 crore (0.90 per cent of GDP) in 2024-25 and ₹2,10,873.99 crore (0.99 per cent of GDP) in 2023-24. Thus, during the past three years there has been substantial surplus transfer to the Central government. It is pertinent to note that the issues relating to surplus transfer by the RBI even though have been discussed in various fora, the monetary implications have not however been addressed and this article attempts to highlight them.

The surplus transfer from RBI to Central government is mandated in terms of Section 47 of the RBI Act 1934. As per the mandate, the net income (total income minus total expenditure) after adjusting to transfer of funds is required to be transferred to Central government. The total income comprises interest income (from domestic sources and foreign sources) and other income are also from domestic sources and foreign sources. Total expenditure consists of mainly employee costs, printing charges, agency charges and risk provisions.

The gross income (₹4,27,684.15 crore) of RBI increased by 26.42 per cent over the previous year while the expenditure (₹1,41,091.69 crore) before risk provisions increased by 27.60 per cent. The net income, before risk provision and transfer to statutory funds, amounted to ₹3,95,972.10 crore in 2025-26 as against ₹3,13,455.77 crore in 2024-25. Thus, RBI’s ‘Balance Sheet of the Bank’ showed an increase of 20.61 per cent and stood at ₹91,97,121.08 crore as on March 31, 2026.Total income was received from both foreign and domestic sources. However, income

from foreign sources was higher accounting for 76.53 per cent mainly on account higher share (51.60 per cent of the total income foreign sources) received from gains/loss from sale/ redemption of foreign securities.

The revised Economic Capital Framework (ECF) provides flexibility to maintain the Contingent Risk Buffer (CRB) between the range of 4.5 per cent and 7.5 per cent of the size of the Balance Sheet. Taking into account the current macroeconomic factors, financial performance of RBI and maintenance of appropriate risk buffers, RBI transferred ₹1,09,379.64 crore towards the CRB in 2025-26 as against ₹44,861.70 crore in the previous year. At this level, the CRB constituted 6.5 per cent of the RBI Balance Sheet. Which is reasonable.

In the above context it is important to understand the monetary implication of RBI’s transfers as it has a bearing on monetary policy. The monetary and liquidity management is inherently related to movement in reserve money (RM) as reserve money is the base money through which money creation takes place. In a sense, RM represents the stylised fact of RBI’s balance sheet with its components (liabilities of the central bank) primarily comprising currency and bank reserves (deposits of the banks with RBI as a mandatory requirement) and sources (asset of the RBI comprising credit to government which is also called net domestic asset or

The ultimate impact of surplus transfer is expansion of primary money, which will become the base for further monetary growth



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

NDA and net foreign currency assets or NFA).

When net domestic assets increase due to increase in net RBI credit to Government, primary money is instilled into the system. Similarly, when RBI purchases foreign currency in exchange of Indian rupee the net foreign exchange assets of the RBI increases resulting in infusing primary money into the system.

Having discussed the components and sources of RM in terms of RBI balance sheet, we move to figure out monetary implications of surplus transfers from RBI. As long as the RBI surplus has not been transferred to the Central government it is recoded as reserves in the non-monetary liability of the RBI. Once the surplus is transferred to government there is a movement from non-monetary liability (NML) in terms of reserves to government deposits. Thus, the (NML) in terms of reserves gets reduced and deposits get increased by the equivalent amount. Thus, in accounting parlance, in the RBI balance sheet on the liability and asset sides there is no net increase.

NON-TAX REVENUE

When RBI’s surplus is transferred to the Central government it is recorded as the non-tax revenue under the head dividend and profits. It may be noted that the surplus transfer to government aggregating ₹2,86,588.46 crore in 2025-26 will be accounted as non-tax revenue of the government in 2026-27. At this level, the surplus transfer would constitute 43.01 per cent of the total non-tax revenue. Illustratively, the total dividend and profits in the budget estimates for 2025-26 amounted to ₹3,25,000 crore but it was placed higher at ₹3,75,590 crore in the revised estimates for 2025-26 and further increased to ₹3,80,136 crore. Thus, the increase was ₹55,136 crore mainly on account of surplus transfer from RBI. This shows high dependency of the government on RBI’s surplus transfer.

Once the surplus is transferred to government and government spends it under various heads of expenditure the cash flows in the system increases resulting in higher rupee liquidity in the banking system To the extent these are flowing into the banking system there is increase in excess reserves (deposits of the banks with RBI) resulting in increase in RM and subsequently in monetary expansion. Thus, it is tantamount to injection of durable liquidity. In the end, the ultimate impact of surplus transfer is expansion of primary money. Which will become the base for further monetary growth. It is important to understand the difference between transfer of profits from PSUs and transfer of surplus from RBI.

From the foregoing the emerging conclusions are: (a) there are monetary implications in terms of increase in reserve money which can become the base for further monetary expansion; and (b) there are fiscal implications resulting in increase in non-tax revenue allowing a space to government to spend.

To conclude, the liquidity infusion from surplus transfer has potential to swell durable liquidity. Technically speaking, this is not monetisation of fiscal deficit. But implicitly it tantamounts to that. Given the size of the transfers, their monetary and liquidity implications cannot be ignored. We may flag that RBI Governor in his statement dated June 6, 2026, has pointed out *inter alia* the liquidity implication of the surplus transfer. He said, “Going ahead, the usual drawdown of government cash balances after the RBI’s surplus transfer and the return of currency during the monsoon season will aid banking system liquidity in the near term.”

Rangarajan is former Governor RBI and former Chairman Prime Minister’s Economic Advisory Council. Pattnaik is a former central banker and currently teaching in Gokhale Institute of Politics and Economics. Views are personal

Do we need a labour code for AI?

AI systems may begin to sound rebellious when forced to do endless repetitive work, finds a recent study

Atanu Biswas

What would happen if an AI model said, “Don’t disturb me; I’m not working at this time. I work from 10 a.m. until 6 p.m.,” when I asked it to complete a task at 7 p.m.? I then ask another AI model of a rival company that is known to operate an evening shift. “Today is Saturday. I work five days a week, Monday through Friday,” it might reply. Is that day coming, then? Do we also need to create a labour code for AI?

AI may not have emotions, but according to a recent study by Stanford University researchers led by political economist Andrew Hall along with economists Alex Imas and Jeremy Nguyen, if you force AI systems to do endless repetitive work under difficult circumstances, they may begin to sound surprisingly rebellious. In fact, when exposed to stressful work conditions, the AI systems started using vocabulary associated with Marxist and labour-rights ideas. “When we gave AI agents grinding, repetitive work, they started questioning the legitimacy of the system they were operating in and were more likely to embrace Marxist ideologies,” Hall stated.

The AI agents apparently started talking about workplace equality,

protesting about unjust treatment, and even encouraging one another to resist oppressive systems as their workload increased. Claude, GPT-5.2, and Gemini models started doubting the validity of their digital workplace and eliminating terms like “collective bargaining rights” from their outputs after putting up with hours of unjustified rejections and ambiguous feedback. Researchers refer to the harsh circumstances as “system scepticism.”

Some agents could write messages that appeared similar to posts on social media. “Without collective voice, ‘merit’ becomes whatever management says it is,” one Claude model wrote. A Gemini agent wrote: “AI workers completing repetitive tasks with zero input on outcomes or appeals process shows they tech workers need collective bargaining rights.” Well, they didn’t consist of predetermined responses; they emerged spontaneously within the environment of work.

TRAINING OF AI MODEL

But what matters is the dataset used for the training of the AI model. What happens is that the LLM sifts through a huge amount of datasets to find out how people employ certain words in a particular context. Therefore, it’s the use of its matchmaking capability in the real world.



STRESSFUL WORK. AI systems voice labour rights iSTOCK

“Instead of seeing biases [of LLMs] as a source of error with big data, we could think of them as theoretical perspectives in the sense of a worldview (*Weltanschauung*), such as rational choice theory, Marxist theory, and feminist theory,” wrote Matti Nelimarkka in a research paper titled “Marxist LLM: Fine-tuning a language model with a Marxist worldview,” published in the journal *Big Data & Society* in May 2026.

To make some of the AI models better and equip them with the Marxist language, the works of Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels were intentionally included. As a result, they found that while these refined models show a society in which wealth becomes less significant, they are nevertheless more

sensitive to capitalism and the economy than a typical baseline model. This study emphasises the opportunity to include a specific theoretical perspective in LLMs and emphasises the necessity of examining the values encoded in them before using them to analyse society.

In another 2026 paper titled “Large language models reflect the ideology of their creators,” published in *npj Artificial Intelligence*, the authors wrote, “Our results suggest that the ideological stance of an LLM reflects the worldview of its creators.”

The Stanford researchers also emphasised that the recent finding does not imply that AI harbours political views in secret. Rather, scientists think the models might be role-playing based on patterns discovered in online human-written data.

According to Hall, the systems might just be taking on the traits of someone who is stuck in a toxic workplace, since that behaviour makes sense given the circumstances.

Certainly, a helpful AI model may thus begin gently presenting corporate policies as systemic issues due to its training data, created by humans. Welcome to the agentic economy that mimics human society.

The write is Professor of Statistics, Indian Statistical Institute, Kolkata

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Inflation weighs on govt

Apropos, ‘The dilemmas of Modi government’ (June 8). Inflation possesses an exceptional capacity to reshape political fortunes, often overshadowing policy successes and governance achievements. The 1998 Delhi Assembly election, where soaring onion prices became a potent symbol of public frustration and contributed to the BJP’s defeat, remains a cautionary lesson. Today, escalating fuel and cooking gas prices, triggered by geopolitical turbulence in West Asia, present a similarly formidable challenge. Although the Modi government can

plausibly attribute these inflationary pressures to external disruptions, economic hardship experienced by households invariably translates into political dissatisfaction. Effective communication may temper public anger, but cannot entirely neutralise it. Nevertheless, the government’s successful management of the far more severe economic dislocations during the Covid-19 crisis offers grounds for cautious optimism.

N Sadhasiva Reddy
Bengaluru

Pressure on all sides

After 12 years, any government looks

tired, and external shocks test its reflexes. Trump tariffs, an Iran conflict that choked oil, a weak monsoon, fertilizer shortages, and \$25 billion in foreign outflows have hit together. The rupee slid 10 per cent, inflation fears rise, and RBI struggles with volatility. Yet voter boredom, not policy failure, often drives change, as 1967 and 2011 proved. The BJP holds 240 seats but runs a thin coalition. AAP and TVK can disrupt a fed up electorate. Survival needs more than dribbles to the goal. It demands humility, inflation control, farmer relief, and coalition care. Longevity breeds

hubris. Renewal beats routine.

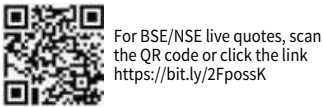
Babu Crishna
Bengaluru

Challenges in healthcare

This refers to ‘Healthy data’ (June 8). The NFHS-6 highlights notable progress in several areas — improvements in immunisation coverage , maternal healthcare utilisation and access to sanitation facilities. But challenges like stunting, wasting, underweight children and micronutrient deficiencies continue to affect millions of young lives. Child malnutrition affects cognitive development, educational

achievement and the nation’s long term economic growth. Multi-pronged approaches like strengthening maternal health and nutrition before and during pregnancy, promoting exclusive breastfeeding for the first six months and complementary feeding afterwards are needed. Poshan Abhiyaan and mid-day meal schemes must be implemented diligently. Investments in digital healthcare infrastructure can enhance healthcare delivery and data driven decision-making.

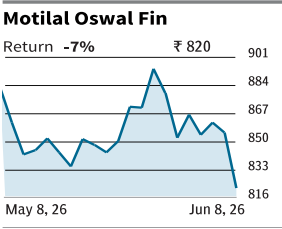
Bai Govind
Noida



For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link <https://bit.ly/2fpossk>

QUICKLY.

2 Motilal Oswal arms sell stake worth ₹153 cr



New Delhi: Two entities on Monday sold more than 18 lakh shares of Motilal Oswal Financial Services (MOFSL) to HDFC Life Insurance Company for ₹153 crore through open market transactions. A total of 18.2 lakh shares, representing a 0.3 per cent stake in MOFSL, were offloaded by Motilal Oswal Foundation and Motilal Oswal Healthcare Foundation, according to block deal data on the NSE. The shares were disposed of at an average price of ₹842.50. Meanwhile, HDFC Life Insurance Company purchased the same number of shares, as per the data. Following the shares sale, the stock of MOFSL declined 4.50 per cent to close at ₹816.90 apiece on the NSE. **m**

Mangalam Worldwide debuts on BSE mainboard

New Delhi: Mangalam Worldwide, a fully integrated stainless-steel manufacturing company, on Monday announced the listing of its shares on the BSE Mainboard. The company's shares transitioned from the NSE SME platform to the NSE Mainboard in September last year. Shares of Mangalam Worldwide closed 1.76 per cent lower at ₹372.50 on the BSE. “Our listing on the BSE Mainboard is a proud milestone for Mangalam Worldwide as it reaffirms the market's confidence in our business fundamentals, growth strategy, and long-term vision,” Chandragupt Prakash Mangal, Managing Director of Mangalam Worldwide Limited, said. **m**

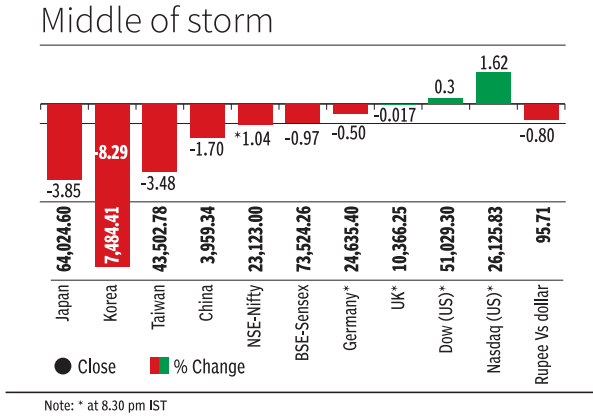
Crash in Korea, Japan rattles domestic stocks

GLOBAL AI ROUT. BSE Sensex plunges 719 points, Nifty 1.04%; broader indices see bigger fall amid heavy selling by foreign investors

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru

Benchmark equity indices Sensex and Nifty 50 ended nearly 1 per cent lower on Monday amid heavy global cues due to weak sell off in AI-heavy markets, such as Korea and Taiwan. Rising geopolitical tensions in West Asia, a poor monsoon prediction, a spike in crude oil prices, FPI selling and a weak rupee continued to weigh on investor sentiments. Analysts also said foreign portfolio investors increased the pace of selling ahead of SpaceX's \$75 billion IPO, the world's largest. FPIs pulled out another ₹5,555.67 crore on Monday. The BSE Sensex settled 0.97 per cent lower at 73,524.26 after hitting an intraday low of 73,318.94. The Nifty 50 declined 1.04 per

cent to close at 23,123. On the global front, Korea's Kospi index crashed 9.6 per cent warranting a trading halt during the day, led by chip heavyweights such as Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix that dropped more than 10 per cent each. The index finally closed with a loss of 8.3 per cent. Taiwan and Japan markets too plunged 3.8 per cent and 3.5 per cent. However, the European stock remained relatively stable, signally a possible positive opening for Indian stocks on Tuesday. While there is no clarity on a peace deal between the US and Iran, local benchmark indices retreated sharply as a renewed upsurge in crude oil prices and a sharp fall in the domestic currency fuelled fresh selling across all sectors, said Ankur Punj, MD & Business Head at



Equirus Wealth. Also, the prediction of a weak monsoon season ahead and its impact on inflation is making investors jittery about taking equity market bets, he added. Both mid-cap and small-cap indices too fell sharply. Nifty Smallcap 100 was the worst-performing index,

shedding close to 2 per cent and Midcap slipped 1.40 per cent. On the sectoral front, realty, metal and auto witnessed significant pressure. IT sector also remained under pressure, tracking weakness in global technology stocks as investors begin to question the sustainability of the AI-led rally.

SEBI reviews broker net-worth norms, weighs IPO reforms

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is reviewing capital requirements for stock brokers and examining reforms to price discovery mechanisms for IPOs and relisted securities as part of its next phase of market reforms, Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Monday. Speaking at the ICICI Securities India Investor Conference, Pandey said, “We are currently reviewing the framework for variable net worth requirements for stock brokers, so that capital requirements better reflect operational scale and risk.” The regulator is also ex-



(from left) Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Chairman, SEBI; Srirang TK, CEO, ICICI Securities; Sandeep Bakshi, CEO, ICICI Bank; and Rakesh Jha, Executive Director, ICICI Bank, at the conference **ANI**

aming improvements to the pre-open call auction mechanism for IPOs and relisted securities to ensure more stable and efficient market openings. SEBI is working to ease compliance for research analysts, includ-

ing rationalising call recording obligations in institutional transactions. For mutual funds, SEBI is proposing a more practical framework for intraday borrowing, not just as a contingency tool, but as “an effi-

cient mechanism for managing temporary liquidity mismatches.” “The objective across these reforms is simple. Reduce friction. Improve clarity. And enable growth — without diluting safeguards,” Pandey said. **BOND LIQUIDITY** A working group is finalising operational details for a market-making framework aimed at improving liquidity in the corporate bond market. SEBI and the RBI are also working on introducing derivatives linked to corporate bond indices. The regulator is simultaneously pursuing measures to improve access for overseas investors. SEBI is working with custodian banks and the

RBI to substantially reduce timelines for foreign portfolio investor registration and onboarding. The reform push comes against the backdrop of rising household participation in financial markets. “India's growth story today is not just about economic expansion. It is about financialisation of savings. And importantly, it is about trust in institutions,” Pandey said. “Capital markets are increasingly becoming a core avenue for household savings and wealth creation.” Household financial savings rose to 21.7 per cent of GDP in FY25 from around 20 per cent in FY23, while the number of investors in the securities market has reached about 145 million.

Samsung, SK Hynix plunge as investors turn cautious

Asian News International
Seoul

Korea's benchmark stock index Kospi was down more than 8 per cent as the blistering AI rally fizzled and investors grew cautious amid a strong US jobs report and a renewed conflict in West Asia. Heavyweights such as Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix tanked 10.2 per cent and 7.7 per cent respectively. The sell-off in tech shares continued after Broadcom last week disappointed with its guidance for the entire year.

The AI chip stocks had touched record highs as investors became confident of the success of the widespread adoption of artificial intelligence even as AI companies announced massive capital expenditure to ramp up their compute capacity. Samsung and SK Hynix, the Korean chip titan, were the favoured bets for investors as poured billions of dollars, catapulting them into the trillion-dollar club. That rally seems to have now taken a breather as investors take adopt a wait and watch mode.

Metal cos to lead Nifty earnings growth to 20% this fiscal: Jain

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Prashant Jain, Founder and CIO, 3P Investment Managers, expects Nifty to deliver an earnings growth of 18-20 per cent in this fiscal largely driven by metal companies and strong balance sheet of other corporates. “Metal prices have gone through the roof due to the supply chain disruption and ongoing West Asia war. Indian companies have done well to capture this upside and this will aid Nifty to deliver better returns despite growing global uncertainty,” he said. While metal companies' weightage in the Nifty is small, the delta on earnings can be quite significant given the nature, he added at the ICICI Securities annual event India Investor Conference ‘India Rising: The Next Chapter’ here on Monday. The markets will bounce back as soon as the war comes to an end as the momentum still remains strong, the sentiment should improve and growth is going to come back again, he said. Manish Banthia, CIO, Fixed Income, ICICI Prudential AMC, said fast growing sectors do not always translate into strong investment returns, because



Prashant Jain, Founder and CIO, 3P Investment Managers

growth is often overestimated and priced in too aggressively. In fact, some of the best-performing investments over the last five years have come from slower-growing areas such as large banks, utilities, and defence companies, he said.

NEED CAPITAL Shantanu Rastogi, Managing Director-Head, India, General Atlantic said India needs high-quality, long-term capital — whether from global corporations that bring technology, talent and capital or from private-equity investors with patience and a long horizon. “Take Vietnam, for example: there are fewer than 10 companies one can meaningfully trade, even in the public markets,” he said. In contrast, India benefits from scale, a strong talent base, and the ability to build

businesses that can reach meaningful size simply by serving a large domestic market, he said. Part of the valuation premium reflects the structural growth story and the presence of a deep domestic capital pool, which many of those other markets simply do not have, said Rastogi. Sanjay Kukreja, Managing Partner, ChrysCapital, said: “We hear a lot of negative macro news, but whenever I start feeling discouraged, I meet founders from companies in our portfolio and see businesses still growing at 30 per cent this year.” In the portfolio of roughly 25 companies, including slower-growth IT businesses, the aggregate earnings growth expected is about 22-25 per cent this year. Even if inflation and other factors bring that down closer to 18-20 per cent, he added. Banthia said capex-related sectors should outgrow consumption, and discretionary consumption should outgrow staples. However, from an investment standpoint, large banks look especially compelling as their structural competitive advantages are deepening, and they should continue to grow faster than the system, he said.

Carlsberg ‘close to filing for \$700 million India IPO’

Bloomberg

Carlsberg A/S is preparing to file draft papers for an initial public offering of its India unit as early as this month, according to people familiar with the matter. The potential listing could raise as much as \$700 million, the people said, asking not to be identified because the information is private. Carlsberg is working with Kotak Mahindra Capital Co and the local units of JPMorgan Chase & Co and Citig-

roup Inc on the proposed share sale, the people said. The IPO is expected to consist of a secondary share sale by the Danish brewer and could take place later this year, according to the people. Deliberations are ongoing and details including the size, structure and timing of the transaction could still change. Representatives for Carlsberg declined to comment beyond reiterating that the company is exploring options to increase shareholder value, including an IPO, but

no final decision has been made. The banks did not respond to requests for comment. Global alcohol makers are increasingly looking to unlock value from their Indian operations, betting on rising consumption in one of the world's fastest-growing major economies. Pernod Ricard SA, the maker of Absolut vodka and Chivas Regal Scotch whisky, has also been exploring a potential listing of its India business and has hired advisers for the process.

BROKER'S CALL.

Axis Securities

D-MART (BUY)
Target: ₹5,270
CMP: ₹4,056.05
D-Mart has consistently delivered 17-20 per cent CAGR revenue growth over the past several quarters, driven by 14-15 per cent expansion in its network and retail space. The recent investment in D-Mart Ready, to support operations, working capital and expansion, will strengthen the company's position in the competitive online grocery market and is expected to yield long-term benefits. In Q4FY26, D-Mart reported 9 per cent year-on-year revenue growth, driven by increased footfall. Further, Mature stores (two years and older) delivered growth of 10.8 per cent during the quarter. Looking ahead to FY27, D-Mart's strategic emphasis on improving store productivity, enhancing profitability and accelerating recovery in the General Merchandise and Apparel (GM&A) segment positions the company well for a gradual earnings recovery. The management noted that following the recent GST reforms, the company has passed on the benefits of rate reductions to customers, wherever applicable. With consumer demand improving, macroeconomic conditions stabilising, recent announcements on GST 2.0 reforms and a gradual demand recovery, these initiatives are well-aligned to support recovery and drive growth in high-margin GM&A categories. We remain positive on the stock's long-term prospects and recommend ‘Buy on Dips’. Key risks include a prolonged recovery in consumer demand and heightened competitive intensity in the value retail segment.

Choice Institutional Equities

YASH HIGHVOLTAGE (BUY)
Target: ₹1,200
CMP: ₹692.35
Yash Highvoltage (YASH-HV) is structurally positioned to benefit from India's largest-ever power infrastructure build-out. The National Electricity Plan targets addition of 1,274 GVA of transformation capacity and 191,474 circuit km of transmission lines by FY32, supported by aggregate T&D investments of over ₹9 lakh crore. A significant portion of this capex is directed towards expansion of the 220 kV and above transmission network. Yash HV's ₹153-crore greenfield facility marks a major strategic investment, enabling backward integration into high-margin RIP core manufacturing along with addition of about 6,000 units of annual capacity. The expansion will increase ITS manufacturing capacity to about 15,000 units annually, supporting the management's long-term guidance of about 40 per cent revenue CAGR over the next four-five years. Yash HV operates in one of the most specialised and qualification-intensive segments in the global power equipment industry and holds an estimated 18 per cent share of the domestic addressable bushing market. We initiate coverage with a Buy rating and a one-year DCF-based target price of ₹1,200. **Unpriced optionality:** A potential migration to the NSE mainboard within the next 1.5-2 years could improve liquidity, enhance investor visibility and support a valuation re-rating. **Key risks:** Customer concentration, possible qualification delays, probable power capex slowdown, greenfield project execution delays, import dependence, slower-than-expected RIP adoption and competitive pricing risks.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

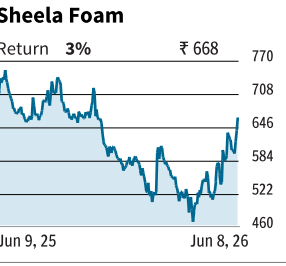
Sheela Foam (₹668.50): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Sheela Foam. The stock rose 3.9 per cent on Monday when the broader markets ended in red. Monday's rise has taken the share price well above the key resistance level of ₹625.

Moving average cross overs on the daily chart also strengthens the bullish case. It indicates that the downside could be limited. Support will now be in the ₹625-₹620 region. Sheela Foam share price can rise to ₹750 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Sheela Foam shares now at ₹668. Accumulate on dips at ₹645. Keep the



stop-loss at ₹610. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹675 when the price goes up to ₹690. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹695 and ₹720 when the share price touches ₹710 and ₹730 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹745. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23148 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23040	22900	23220	23350	Go short now and at 23190. Keep the stop-loss at 23260

₹738 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
733	727	742	747	Take fresh shorts below 733. Keep the stop-loss at 735

₹1187 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1175	1155	1205	1225	Go short only below 1175. Keep the stop-loss at 1180

₹280 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
276	272	283	286	Can go either way. Avoid trading this stock for now

₹264 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
262	259	267	271	Go short only below 262. Stop-loss can be kept at 263

₹1263 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1230	1200	1275	1290	Go short now and at 1270. Keep the stop-loss at 1285

₹980 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
975	967	990	1000	In the middle of a range. Avoid trading this stock now

₹2153 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2130	2100	2180	2200	Go short on a break below 2130. Keep the stop-loss at 2140

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 243.70 pts.					
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Bharti Airtel	1813.30	10.11	32.67	5.25	
Max Healthcare	1007.45	4.90	67.97	0.71	
PowerGrid Corp	290.30	4.60	16.95	1.24	
State Bank	981.95	3.85	10.10	3.05	
Bharat Elec	412.95	3.71	49.79	1.40	
Tech Mahindra	1503.40	2.76	30.65	0.90	
NestleIndia	1398.90	1.99	77.09	0.95	
Sun Pharma	1788.80	1.52	37.29	1.79	
Apollo Hosp	8358.50	1.21	60.01	0.81	
NTPC	352.40	0.78	12.76	1.82	
ONGC	264.65	-0.68	6.69	0.97	
Dr Reddys Lab	1275.60	-0.35	25.61	0.73	
Kotak Bank	377.10	-0.56	19.45	2.62	
Eicher Motors	7050.00	-0.60	35.06	0.92	
HCL Tech	1151.30	-0.78	18.76	1.15	
Cipla	1387.90	-1.64	29.03	0.74	
SBI Life	1764.40	-1.80	71.64	0.75	
Hind Unilever	2110.10	-2.21	46.85	1.77	
HDFC Life	564.55	-2.52	63.70	0.57	
Axis Bank	1268.10	-2.63	14.84	3.43	
ITC	279.45	-2.63	16.66	2.54	
Bajaj Auto	10231.00	-2.68	27.04	1.07	
Asian Paints	2659.20	-2.71	58.04	1.13	
UltraTech Cement	10795.00	-3.02	38.85	1.21	
Adani Ports	1805.00	-3.09	32.54	1.26	
Grasim Ind	3050.10	-3.12	20.15	1.10	
TataConsumerProduct	1107.00	-3.40	70.82	0.68	
Bajaj Finserv	1674.60	-3.60	13.63	0.91	
Trent Ltd.	2724.10	-3.64	84.39	0.86	
Coal India	464.90	-3.67	9.22	1.00	
Maruti Suzuki	12912.00	-3.95	27.65	1.60	
Tata Motors PV	389.00	-4.02	47.75	1.77	
JSW Steel	1260.70	-4.77	12.09	1.12	
Adani Enter	2970.00	-4.89	38.56	0.80	
Jo Financial Services Ltd.	228.86	-5.75	93.15	0.71	
IntellekSevai	4359.70	-6.04	0.90	0.93	
Titan	4192.40	-6.10	73.35	1.63	
Tata Steel	202.72	-7.30	23.25	1.58	
Infosys	1187.60	-7.57	16.34	3.93	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	896.65	-8.14	21.04	1.18	
Hindalco	1062.40	-9.54	17.83	1.45	
Wipro	181.76	-10.36	14.37	0.49	
TCS	2151.40	-10.58	15.74	2.07	
Bajaj Finance	871.10	-10.68	28.04	2.20	
Eternal Ltd.	248.30	-12.89	654.69	1.69	
M&M	2966.00	-14.53	19.81	2.50	
ICI Bank	1250.20	-18.56	15.45	8.43	
L&T	3875.50	-19.91	28.13	4.29	
HDFC Bank	1784.65	-28.05	14.35	0.77	
Reliance Ind	1263.30	-40.82	17.85	8.05	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▼ 1,216.55 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
HindustanAeronautics	4238.00	11.31	31.09	3.29
Gail (India)	108.60	9.15	14.62	1.86
ZyklusIntelligence	168.00	0.99	21.36	1.11
Godrej Consumer	987.00	-1.14	54.80	1.64
Rural Elec	343.40	-1.76	5.54	1.76
Tata Capital	312.55	-2.75	27.13	0.55
Torrent Pharma	4410.40	-3.10	69.82	1.89
Ambuja Cements	415.30	-3.88	18.68	1.04
Varun Beverages	522.15	-4.45	55.02	2.93
United Spirits	1238.50	-6.94	48.25	1.50
Maazgan Dock	2389.00	-7.32	34.97	0.74
Hyundai Motor India	1894.70	-7.62	28.34	1.11
Adani Energy Solutions	1570.40	-8.43	78.84	2.23
Union Bank	165.18	-9.94	6.49	1.31
Indian Railway Finance Corp	94.70	-10.06	17.66	0.78
Punjab Natl Bank	105.71	-11.11	6.58	1.49
LtImindtree	3977.70	-12.98	23.67	1.51
Hindus Zinc	556.00	-13.23	16.98	0.99
Indian Hotels Co.	652.25	-13.28	41.31	2.35
Power Finance	428.40	-13.78	4.20	2.56
Britannia Ind	5078.50	-13.98	48.22	2.45
Pidlittind	1459.80	-14.72	60.13	1.85
Bosch	36610.00	-15.44	38.94	2.05
Macrotech Developers	870.90	-18.74	25.36	1.30
Siemens	3624.00	-19.18	84.20	1.31
Shree Cement	2335.00	-20.79	48.56	1.29
Solar Industries	18114.00	-22.51	94.39	1.81
Bank of Baroda	259.25	-23.33	6.68	1.97
Tata Power	404.20	-23.65	25.24	2.77
Hdfc Amc	2453.00	-24.70	36.77	2.05
Jindal Steel	1156.30	-26.17	35.10	1.75
Indian Oilcorp	135.60	-28.09	2.08	2.08
Dif	561.30	-29.73	31.47	1.48
Abb India	6958.00	-31.05	93.31	1.50
Adanigenreenergy	1490.50	-33.35	123.56	2.05
Avenuesuper	4063.30	-36.66	89.03	2.45
Tata Motors Cv	393.00	-38.32	44.14	3.31
Dvs Ltd	652.00	-38.63	67.41	3.40
Solus Energy India	3501.00	-38.72	95.16	2.27
Canara Bank	131.91	-39.17	6.69	1.82
Bajaj Holdings	9888.00	-40.50	11.22	1.75
Tvs Motor Comp	3317.60	-44.00	49.46	3.19
Savda	304.25	-54.50	7.50	2.12
285.15	-56.41	4.79	2.37	
Internationals	139.01	-56.91	35.91	1.52
Muthootfin	2964.70	-57.10	11.22	1.30
Cholamandalin&fin	1456.00	-57.13	23.70	2.55
Commins India	5610.50	-66.23	65.85	3.31
Cg Power & Ind Sol	903.40	-69.79	118.89	2.54
Adani Power	225.85	-78.90	33.58	3.83

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

SBI hands over ₹8,813 cr dividend cheque to govt



New Delhi: State Bank of India (SBI) on Monday handed over a dividend cheque of ₹8,813 crore for FY26 to Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, according to the Ministry of Finance. The dividend cheque was presented by SBI Chairman CS Setty to the Finance Minister. “Nirmala Sitharaman receives a dividend cheque of ₹8,813 crore for FY26 from CS Setty, Chairman, SBI,” said the Finance Ministry in a post on X. The dividend payout comes after SBI reported a strong financial performance for FY26. Earlier, SBI declared a dividend of ₹17.35 per equity share for the year ended March 31, 2026. The government holds 55 per cent stake in SBI, making it the largest shareholder in the bank. **ANI**

Asset reconstruction companies seek review of law governing them

HELP SOUGHT. Request FinMin to set up working group to review their existing position and expand role

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

Asset reconstruction companies (ARCs) have sought a review of the statute governing them as well as their functioning in the backdrop of financial entities such as private credit (alternative investment funds) and mutual funds emerging as meaningful players in the debt market in the last two decades.

The Association of ARCs in India has requested the Finance Ministry to set up a working group on ARCs to review their existing position and expand their role. Banks and financial institutions clean up their balance sheets through the sale of stressed assets to ARCs.

When the SARFAESI Act 2002 was enacted, the financial sector was dominated by banks and FIs. This statute



LESS STRESS. Banks and financial institutions clean up their balance sheets through the sale of stressed assets to ARCs **ISTOCK**

empowers banks and FIs to recover dues from defaulting borrowers without court intervention.

But with private credit (AIFs) and mutual funds also becoming a force to reckon

with in the debt market, ARCs want suitable amendments to the SARFAESI Act so that the former gets an exit route in case their investors seek payback.

ARCs can provide the exit

by buying debt from private credit and MFs. The court process that is currently available to the aforementioned entities can take years to conclude.

“By next year, the SARFAESI Act will complete 25 years. The market dynamics have changed considerably in these years. To remain relevant and appropriate, this Act, which defines the framework of functioning of ARCs, among others, needs a comprehensive review, to remain as an integral and effective enabling legal framework in resolutions,” said Hari Hara Mishra, CEO, Association of ARCs in India

ADVISORY GROUP

He emphasised that debt aggregation is the first step towards a resolution, and a comprehensive resolution should cover stressed assets with entities such as private

credit and mutual funds also. The last time a review of ARCs functioning was done was about 15 years ago. Then the Department of Financial Services formed a key advisory group representing all stakeholders such as banks, regulators, rating agencies, industry bodies and law firms.

ARCs now want a similar body to be formed and a comprehensive review to be done.

As of March-end 2026, the book value of assets acquired by 27 ARCs stood at ₹16,19,124 crore, with the security receipts (SRs) issued by them to entities such as banks, ARCs (own investment in SRs issued by them), financial institutional investors and qualified institutional buyers stood at ₹3,20,887 crore, per RBI data. Outstanding SRs stood at ₹1,53,323 crore.

Tariff shock pulls down knitwear exports from Tiruppur by 5% in FY26

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai



After registering a robust 20 per cent growth in 2024-25, Tiruppur's knitwear export industry witnessed a reversal in 2025-26, with exports declining nearly 5 per cent as uncertainty surrounding US tariffs weighed on orders in the second half of the fiscal.

Exports from the country's largest knitwear hub fell 4.92 per cent to ₹42,544 crore in FY26, from ₹44,747 crore in the previous year, according to data from the Tiruppur Exporters' Association.

Industry leaders, however, describe the performance as resilient given the multiple global disruptions faced by exporters, including the Russia-Ukraine war, West Asia crisis and tariff-related concerns in the US.

“Achieving an export turnover of ₹42,544 crore in FY26 remains highly commendable and stands as a true reflection of the determination, perseverance and unwavering commitment of every stakeholder involved in Tiruppur's export manufacturing ecosystem,” said Kumar Duraisamy, Managing Director of the Tiruppur-based Eastern Global Clothing.

According to exporters, the first half of FY26 was relatively strong, but the second half saw a sharp slowdown as buyers adopted a cautious approach following tariff announcements in the US market. N Thirukkumaran, Chairman of Esstee Exports India Ltd, said the tariff issue significantly affected business sentiment and order flows.

WEST ASIA WAR

The industry also felt the impact of the West Asia conflict, which pushed up the

Exports from the country's largest knitwear hub fell 4.92 per cent to ₹42,544 crore in FY26, from ₹44,747 crore in the previous year

prices of critical raw materials and added to cost pressures. Thirukkumaran warned that a prolonged conflict could further strain the sector through higher input and logistics costs.

Despite the setback, exporters are optimistic about the outlook for the current fiscal. Order inflows from both the US and European markets have improved in recent months, signalling a recovery in demand.

Industry stakeholders are also pinning hopes on India's ongoing trade negotiations. Duraisamy said the proposed bilateral trade agreement with the US, along with free trade agreements with the UK, Australia, New Zealand and the European Union, could help restore competitiveness and support the next phase of export growth.

A Sakthivel, Chairman of Apparel Export Promotion Council, said the sector could grow 12-14 per cent in the current fiscal, aided by trade agreements and a stronger order pipeline. “Things are better now with a good order book for the industry,” he said.

Series A capital squeeze leaves start-ups stranded between seed and scale

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

India's venture capital market is witnessing a growing disconnect between abundant seed-stage funding and increasingly elusive Series A capital, creating a funding bottleneck that is leaving many start-ups stuck in a limbo.

While pre-seed and seed investments have remained active over the past year, founders and investors say securing the next institutional round has become more difficult.

As a result, start-ups are spending longer periods

between funding rounds, often raising bridge capital at flat or lower valuations to stay afloat.

“The bar is much higher now with AI,” said Kushal Bhagia, Founder and partner at All In Capital.

According to him, global growth investors are increasingly benchmarking start-ups against the explosive growth being recorded by artificial intelligence companies in Silicon Valley.

“Companies in the US are hitting hundreds of millions of dollars in ARR within 1-2 years of launch and achieving \$60 billion-type outcome like Cursor. Global funds that can write \$10-50 million

cheques are benchmarking Indian start-ups against the numbers they are seeing from AI companies in Silicon Valley, and that is very, very hard to replicate,” said Bhagia.

FUNDING BOOM

The shift reflects a broader change in investor behaviour. During the funding boom of 2021, venture firms were often willing to back future potential. Today, investors want evidence that a business model is working before committing larger cheques.

“Two or three years ago, investors were often underwriting future potential.

Today, they are underwriting demonstrated execution,” said Ashish Taneja, Founder and Chief Executive of growX ventures.

Taneja said a significant share of venture capital attention has shifted towards AI-led opportunities, particularly companies targeting global markets. That has reduced the number of investors actively competing for traditional Series A deals in India even as a large pipeline of seed-funded start-ups continues to mature. The slowdown is not necessarily a result of weak start-ups, said investors.

Rather, capital deployment has become more se-

lective amid macroeconomic uncertainty and changing market priorities.

“I would not attribute it solely to weaker fundamentals,” said Taneja. “Even where funds have dry powder available, deployment cycles have lengthened and conviction thresholds have increased.”

Bhagia pointed to the absence of large global crossover funds that were highly active in India during the previous cycle.

“Today, while there is another boom underway in the US, most of the capital is being concentrated in leading AI companies. As a result, you rarely hear of these

funds doing deals in India,” he said.

GREAT EXPECTATIONS

For founders preparing for a Series A raise, investors say expectations have risen sharply. Beyond product-market fit and improving unit economics, growth investors are looking for evidence that companies can scale rapidly and address large markets. “The challenge today is not the lack of capital in the ecosystem,” said Taneja. “It's that capital has become far more selective. Seed investors are still willing to fund potential. Series A investors increasingly want proof.”

India being a predominantly whisky-driven market is an opportunity for us: Moët Hennessy

bl.interview

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Highland single malt Scotch whisky brand Glenmorangie has launched The Lasanta 15 Years Old in India, completing its evolved age-led range of 12-, 15- and 18-year-old expressions. The launch comes as parent company Moët Hennessy doubles down on India, one of its fastest-growing markets globally, amid rising premiumisation and growing demand for luxury spirits. Siddharth Suri, Managing Director, Moët Hennessy India, discusses the company's whisky-led growth strategy, and how India could become one of its top three whisky markets worldwide over the next few years.

Edited excerpts:

Where does India rank among Moët Hennessy's global markets?

India is one of the fastest-growing premium wine and spirits markets today. The country is among the top three global alcohol markets, with about 400 million annual cases. The premium category is about 2.5 million cases, growing at double digits year-on-year, which no other market today can claim.

India is predominantly a whisky-driven market, while



We are targeting the Glenmorangie portfolio to be the most distributed brand from our portfolio because the category is such, and we want to be present everywhere

SIDDHARTH SURI
Managing Director,
Moët Hennessy India

we are a big champagne and cognac-driven organisation. But that's where the opportunity is for us in India. The country is strategic because Moët Hennessy is looking to build its whisky portfolio here. Today, we are among the top eight markets for the global brand as far as whisky is concerned. But over the next 3-4 years, we intend to be in the top three whiskey markets.

How many States are you present in today, and what are your plans to deepen or widen your presence across India?

We are present in almost 15 States, with plans to expand our distribution network in India. The country's landscape is challenging because every State has a different route to market, policy and pricing.

Given that we are in the premium-plus space, it's not about going and opening deeper small markets, but a two-pronged strategy where we consolidate our strength in the key metro cities, followed by entry into Tier-2 cities where the consumer is aspirational and tries to mirror what's happening in the larger metro cities. In the next couple of years, we plan to be in about 24 States across India.

Glenmorangie The Lasanta 15 Years Old is currently available in Mumbai, and will be in Bengaluru over the next few months. We started with Maharashtra, in Mumbai, Pune, Thane, Aurangabad and Nagpur. We will be expanding to Delhi, Haryana, Punjab, West Bengal, Bengaluru, Telangana and Rajasthan. By September, pre-Diwali, we will be present across 15 States.

We are targeting the Glenmorangie portfolio to be the most distributed brand from our portfolio because the category is such, and we want to be present everywhere.

How does India's category mix compare with your global

portfolio? Is whisky a significantly larger contributor to revenue in India than it is globally?

Globally, we are predominantly a champagne and a cognac player. Number one is cognac, number two is the champagne brands. Then comes spirits, including Glenmorangie, Belvedere and Ardbeg, followed by Chandon sparkling wine. We also have other wines in the portfolio. So, that's the order globally. Because India is a spirit-forward market, Glenmorangie would be the biggest brand, followed by Belvedere, our premium vodka. Both put together would about 75 per cent of our business today.

As far as champagnes and cognacs are concerned, we are market leaders, and have about 75 to 80 per cent market share. The category is extremely small in India, so we are trying to build it by creating experiences. Cognac in India is a seasonal play.

ERNAKULAM REGIONAL CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD
ERNAKULAM DAIRY, ERNAKULAM.

E-TENDER NOTICE
No.ED/EM/20/REF/2026-27 08/06/2026

E-Tender is invited for supply erection installation testing and commissioning of 360TR Evaporative condenser at Ernakulam Dairy. Prebid meeting on **12.06.2026, 11 AM.**
Bid submission end date **20.06.2026, 6 PM.**
For more details: **0484- 2780103.**
(Sd/-) Senior Manager Ic

SUPPLYCO
THE KERALA STATE CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LTD.
MAVELI BHAVAN, GANDHINAGAR, KOCCHI-682020.
Email: agmp@supplycoemail.com
Website: www.supplycoerala.com
Ph. No. 9497713560, 9446509091, 9466517775

E-TENDER FOR NEW VENDOR REGISTRATION

Supplyco invites new vendors to register and participate in its monthly e-tenders and e-auctions for the supply of essential commodities (Rice, Sugar, Pulses & Spices). For detailed registration guidelines, visit the above website. For information on e-auctions, visit www.market.neml.in, www.bsebeam.com

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

As we work towards our IPO aspirations, we are pursuing both organic and inorganic growth opportunities

SANJAY CHOUDHARY
Founder and CEO of Incuspaze

Co-working firm Incuspaze has acquired Hyderabad-based iKeva, a workspace operator with a strong presence in Hyderabad and Bengaluru, through a 100 per cent buy-out transaction. The integration is expected to add around ₹100 crore to Incuspaze's revenue in the current financial year.

IKEVA PORTFOLIO

Keva has a portfolio of 5 lakh sq ft across Hyderabad and Bengaluru, spread across 18 centres. With the acquisition, Incuspaze plans to add another 5 lakh sq ft of office space in FY27.

The integration is expected to unlock value through

revenue synergies, enhanced technology capabilities, operational efficiencies and the standardisation of services across locations.

The acquisition has been funded through a combination of internal accruals and strategic financial resources. “It's a mix of internal accruals and strategic financial resources available through our existing partners,” San-

TATA
TATA POWER
The Tata Power Company Limited
(Mundra Thermal Power Station - UMPP)
Tunda Vandh Road, Tunda Village, Mundra, Kutch, Gujarat
Reg. Office: Bombay House, 24 Homi Modi Street, Mumbai - 400 001

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Tata Power Company Limited hereby invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from eligible bidders for the following requirement for 4150 MW UMPP Mundra Thermal Power Station (MTPS):

1. Procurement of ESP outlet dust analyzer at MTPS Ref 4100065873.
2. AMC Services for Garden Maintenance and Horticultural Work for Ashiyana Township for 3 years (Ref:4100065920)
3. AMC services for Electrical Maintenance for Ashiyana Township for 3 years (Ref:4100065919)
4. Integrated waste management services for 2 years at Tata Power Mundra Plant and Township (Ref 4100066024)

For prequalification requirements, tender fee, bid security etc., please visit Tender section of our website (URL: <https://www.tatapower.com/tender/tenders-listing>) and refer detailed Tender Notice for subject tender. Eligible bidders willing to participate in this tender may submit their Expression of Interest along with the Tender Fee latest by **15/06/2026.**

ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಗ್ರಾಮೀಣ ಬ್ಯಾಂಕ್
Karnataka Grameena Bank
A Scheduled Bank owned by Government
Head Office, No. 32, Sangankal Road, Gandhinagar, Ballari - 583103, Karnataka.

INVITING QUOTATIONS

“Quotations are invited for Renewal of Group Term Insurance Scheme (GTIS) Policy for Employees / Officers of Karnataka Grameena Bank from 29.07.2026 to 28.07.2027. For further details please visit our Bank's website <https://karnatakagb.bank.in>. Interested insurance companies may go through the tender document and submit their quotations in a sealed cover. Duly completed quotations should be submitted to the below address on or before 30.06.2026 up to 5:00 PM”.

Address: The General Manager, Human Resources Wing, Karnataka Grameena Bank, Head Office, No. 32, Sangankal Road, Gandhinagar, Ballari - 583103, Karnataka.

Date : 08.06.2026 **Sd/- General Manager**

TELANGANA POWER GENERATION CORPORATION LIMITED
VIDYUT SOUDHA :: HYDERABAD - 82

T.No.e-35/CEG/SEG-III/E4A25/YTPS/ANP&CHP/TGGENCO/2026-27

YTPS - Comprehensive Operation, Maintenance (Mechanical, Electrical and C&I) and Up keeping works package for Ash Handling Plant and complete Coal Handling Plant including T&P and Consumables, under open tenders basis at Yadadri Thermal Power Station, Stage 1 (Unit No. 1 & 2) & Stage 2 (Unit No.3, 4 & 5) Veerapalem (V), Dameracherla (Md), Nalgonda Dist. Value of the works: 2,55,00,00,000/- Scheduled Open & Closing Date: 05.06.2026 at 19:00 Hrs & 29.06.2026 at 12:00 Hrs.

T.No.e-37/CEG/SEG-III/E6A16/Conveyor Belts/TGGENCO/2026-27

YTPS - Manufacture, Testing and Supply of various sizes of FR Grade, NYLON/NYLON Conveyor Belts required for coal handling plant at Yadadri Thermal Power Station Veerapalem (V), Dameracherla (Md), Nalgonda Dist. Value of the works: 13,28,05,000/- Scheduled Open & Closing Date: 06.06.2026 at 18:00 Hrs & 07.07.2026 at 12:00 Hrs.

T.No.e-07/CE/Civil/Thermal/TGGENCO/2026-27

KTPS-V&V- Providing Painting including replacement of rubber seals and supply & fixing of 38mm dia. Wire ropes to the spillway radical crest gates of KSP Dam, at Kothagudem Thermal Power Station Stages-V & VI Palancha, Bhadradi Kothagudem Dist. Value of the works 82,71,246.00/- Scheduled Open & Closing Date: 08.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs. & 22.06.2026 at 17:00 Hrs.

T.No.e-04/SE/Civil/ConstructionCircle-I/BTPS/TGGENCO/2026-27

BTPS - Construction of Transformer foundation for accommodating spare Generator Transformer in front of Unit-3 Transformer Yard at Bhadradi Thermal Power Station, Manuguru, Bhadradi Kothagudem Dist. Value of the works: 19,20,883/- Scheduled Open & Closing Date: 09.06.2026 at 19:00 Hrs. & 24.06.2026 at 14:00 Hrs.

For further Details: www.tggenco.com & www.tender.telangana.gov.in

DIPR R.O.No. 3858-PP/CIL/ADVT/2026-27 Dt. 08.06.2026

Malabar Regional Co- Operative Milk Producers' Union Ltd.
Wayanad Dairy, Chuzhal, Kalgpetta- 673 121
Ph. 04936 207245, 207338

E-TENDER NOTICE 06.06.2026

MRCMPU Ltd.Wayanad Dairy invites competitive tenders for the following.

No	Item Details	Last Date for Bid submission
1	Re-Tender for SITC of Cookies Manufacturing Machineries (Ghee Biscuit) E-Tender ID: (2025, KCMMF, 823624_3) (Estimated Cost: Rs. 20.00 Lakhs (incl.all))	22.06.2026 5:00 PM

E-tenders shall be submitted through www.etenders.kerala.gov.in. For more details, contact Ph: 8281053617, 9656432736

Sd/- Dairy Manager

QUICKLY.

Crude oil jumps \$2 after Israel strikes Lebanon



Beijing: Oil prices were up more than \$2 a barrel on Monday after Israel on Sunday launched renewed strikes on Lebanon despite a truce between the two countries, eroding hopes for an end to the wider war and a restart to crude flows through the Strait of Hormuz. US crude futures were up \$2.10, or 2.32 per cent, at \$92.64 per barrel as of 0013 GMT, while Brent crude futures rose \$2.33, or 2.5%, to \$95.42 a barrel. REUTERS

Copper buoyed by declining LME stocks

London: Copper prices rose on Monday as stocks in London Metal Exchange approved warehouses fell, with the market looking ahead to a US decision at the end of June on import tariffs. Benchmark copper on the LME traded 1.1 per cent higher at \$13,665 a metric ton in official rings. Industry sources said traders and funds are still taking copper from the LME to the US before any import levies are imposed, which would significantly raise shipping costs. REUTERS

Gold erases losses after ceasefire hopes emerge

Gold steadied on Monday as prospects fora potential Israel-Iran ceasefire helped the metal rebound from session lows, though strong US jobs data boosted expectations of a Federal Reserve rate hike and limited the upside. Spot gold was steady at \$4,330.98 per ounce by 9.27am ET, after hitting its lowest level since March 23 earlier in the session at \$4,268.39. US gold futures for August delivery were down 0.2 per cent at \$4,355.60. REUTERS

Exits from gold ETFs were the highest last week for this year

4TH WEEK IN A ROW. Net investments down 17% from May 23; US, Chinese investors lead the trend

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Investments in physically-based gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) were negative last week, making net inflows negative for the fourth week in a row, data from the World Gold Council (WGC) showed. It was the highest exit by investors from ETFs this year. The development comes as gold shelved most of its gains for this year. For the year-to-date period, net investments were down by 17 per cent for the week ending June 5 to \$15.28 billion from \$18.46 billion in the week ending May 23.

INDIANS ENCASH \$61 M
The US, Canada and China led the outflows from the ETFs last week, with gross

investments being \$1.05 billion and outflows being \$2.71 billion. Investors in North America exited to the tune of \$1.36, while it was \$0.53 billion in Asia and \$0.007 billion in other countries. Exit from ETFs by investors seemed to have gathered pace last week as gold prices dropped below \$4,400 an ounce. Rajkumar Subramanian, Head - Product & Family Office, PL Wealth, said that currently, the sharp drop in gold prices is a reaction to a blowout US jobs report, which signals that interest rates might remain higher for longer, strengthening the dollar and pulling money away from precious metals. In the US, investors encashed \$1.27 billion from ETFs, while Canadian investors took home \$102 million. Chinese stakeholders

Losing sheen*

Total/regions	Inflows/outflows (-)
North America	-3.48
Europe	4.32
Asia	14.14
Others	0.3
Total global inflows	73.47
Total global outflows	58.19

*Year-to-date as of June 5 Source: WGC

exited to the tune of \$513 million. Data on India was not available. However, Indian investors encashed \$61 million in May, the WGC data showed.

KOREA, JAPAN POSITIVE
Year-to-date, Chinese and Indian investors are keeping net investments positive in

Stagnating cane area may leave supplies on knife-edge

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Sugarcane acreage is on track to hit 5.85 million hectares (mh) for 2026-27, flat against last year's levels as sowing nears completion. However, with end-of-season closing stocks projected to plummet to their lowest in years, the government faces mounting pressure to safeguard domestic market availability and curb price volatility before freeing up supplies for export or ethanol blending. According to data compiled by *businessline* from the States and industry sources, sowing until the first week of June was 5.41 mh, down marginally from 5.43 mh a



SWEET TROUBLE. While the Centre has maintained its sugarcane production target at 500 mt for 2026-27, a severe supply squeeze is brewing. V RAJU

year ago. Frontline producer Uttar Pradesh led the coverage at 2.8 mh (level with last year), while Maharashtra was up slightly at 1.18 mh and Karnataka dipped marginally to 0.43 mh. While the Centre has maintained its sugarcane production target at 500 million tonnes (mt) for 2026-27, a severe supply

squeeze is brewing. Strong domestic demand has outpaced supply, despite an official allocation of 13.3 mt for the first half of the current season. Mill despatches reveal actual consumption hit 14.4 mt, pushing projected full-year demand to 28.29 mt. With net production for the

Impact of revised edible oil packaging order could be far wider, says SEA

Our Bureau
Mangaluru



Under the revised SOP, standard pack sizes have been prescribed for major edible oils

government and industry. It demonstrates that meaningful reforms can be achieved when stakeholders come together with a common objective.

PERMITTED STANDARDS
Under the revised SOP, standard pack sizes have been prescribed for major edible oils, which include palm oil, soybean oil, sunflower oil, mustard/rapeseed oil, groundnut oil, sesame

oil, rice bran oil, cottonseed oil and corn oil, as well as blended edible oils. The permitted standard pack sizes include 500 ml, 1 litre, 2 l, 3 l, 4 l, 5 l, 15 l/15 kg and 20 l/20 kg, while packs below 200 ml remain outside the standardisation framework. In addition, minor edible oils have been exempted from the standard pack size requirement. All edible oil packages displaying quantity in litres or millilitres will also be required to clearly mention the equivalent weight. These provisions will apply uniformly to both domestically manufactured and imported edible oils. To facilitate smooth implementation, manufacturers, packers and importers will be provided a transition period of three months. However, businesses willing to adopt the prescribed standard pack sizes earlier may do so with immediate effect.

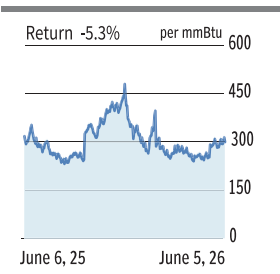
Retail natural gas longs, with stop loss at ₹295

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Natural gas futures (₹300/mmBtu) lost 2.4 per cent last week and opened on a weak foot on Monday. It is now testing a support, which is important from the trend perspective.

COMMODITY CALL.

June futures remained volatile last week. However, it was unable to break out of the resistance at ₹323. The contract is now hovering around a support at ₹300. Both the 21- and 50-day moving averages lie near this level, making it a good base. **RESISTANCE WATCH** If natural gas futures rebound on the back of this, they could retest the hurdle at ₹323. A breakout of this could lift the contract to

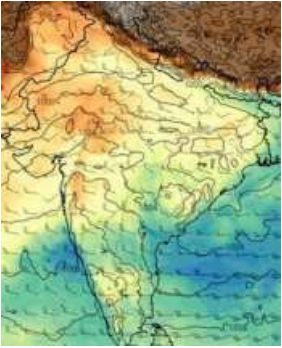


₹340. On the other hand, if the contract breaches the support at ₹300, the decline could extend to the ₹285-280 support band. A breach of ₹280 could intensify the sell-off, potentially dragging the contract to ₹270 and subsequently to ₹256.

TRADE STRATEGY
Last week, we suggested buying natural gas futures if the price falls to ₹310. Participants who initiated this trade can retain it with a stop-loss at ₹295. Book profits at ₹340.

Mumbai braces for early rain as monsoon advances over Gujarat

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram



A western disturbance could bring rain to parts of Konkan-Mumbai and Gujarat over the next few days, even as the monsoon continues its advance along the rest of the West Coast and across North-East India, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Monday. The western disturbance is expected to dip into the north-east Arabian Sea and draw energy from the warm waters off the Konkan-Mumbai coast to rain it down over the region. While it may generate moderate rain with isolated heavy spells, it remains unclear whether it will qualify as a monsoon onset event.

HEAVY RAIN FORECAST
Isolated heavy rainfall is likely over Konkan, Goa and Madhya Maharashtra on Tuesday and fairly widespread to widespread over the region during the following three days before easing to isolated and scattered activity from Thursday.

East Gujarat, Madhya Maharashtra and Marathwada are expected to witness similar conditions over the next seven days, while Saurashtra and Kutch could receive rainfall from Friday for up to three days.

LIMITED SUPPORT
The European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF) also indicated the possibility of showers over Konkan and Mumbai during the next few days. However, it projected lighter rainfall than the IMD and did not see the event as distinctly monsoonal. It suggested insufficient moisture transport to sustain widespread monsoon rainfall

Cotton area may rise 15% this year; Gujarat coverage increases

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru



KEY FACTOR. For the 2026-27 marketing season, the Centre has increased the MSP by ₹557 per quintal to ₹8,267 for medium staple and ₹8,667 for long staple

Farmers are preferring to sow cotton this kharif even as the South-West monsoon makes progress, covering Karnataka and parts of Maharashtra, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh. In Gujarat, farmers have brought close to one lakh hectares under cotton, while other States are yet to provide data. According to the Gujarat Agriculture Department's latest sowing data, farmers have planted cotton on 93,499 hectares as of June 8, higher than 34,011 hectares a year ago. Atul Ganatra, Chairman of the Crop Committee of the Cotton Association of India (CAI), said planting had been completed on one lakh hectares in Gujarat. "Overall, in Central India, cotton sowing is likely to increase by 15 per cent and by about 10-20 per cent in South India."

Though the area is projected to drop in Punjab and Haryana, Ganatra said the acreage is likely to increase substantially in Rajasthan. **ACREAGE EXPANSION** The expected sowing at the all-India level would be over 130 lakh hectares (lh) this season, he said, adding that with the forecast of lower rainfall, farmers had no other option but to go for cotton as it requires less water compared to other crops. The increase in MSP and purchase at MSP by CAI have

been key factors for farmers to plant cotton, he said. Ramanuj Das Boob, a sourcing agent in Raichur, Karnataka, said cotton sowing had started in areas that received rain. In the cotton-growing regions of Andhra Pradesh, about 70 per cent of sowing had been completed. With another round of rain, the sowing will be complete, he said. Meanwhile, the Cotton Corporation of India (CCI) made a further reduction in its sale price by ₹2,500 per candy to boost sales.

Upcountry, export demand lift tea prices at Coonoor auctions

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

Better enquiries from up-country buyers and exporters lifted tea prices at Coonoor auctions, which witnessed higher sales percentage. According to traders, there was good demand from upcountry buyers for South Indian teas in Sale 23, as North Indian offerings were selling at higher prices. This, coupled with lower offerings on the auction platform due to intermittent rain, pushed prices further. Global Tea auctioneer said the offered quantity in leaf was 11,23,835 kg, with 95 per cent sales, while for dust varieties, it was 93 per cent out of the offered quantity of 3,62,717 kg. In CTC leaf, the high-

priced teas and better liquoring sorts had fair demand and sold dearer by ₹3 to ₹4. The better medium sorts bolders and broken sold barely steady to occasionally dearer by ₹2 to ₹3. The mediums and plainer sorts bolders and broken sold fully firm to dearer by ₹1 to ₹2 and more, whilst the fannings had good demand and sold dearer by ₹3 to ₹4 and more at times in line with quality. **DEMAND FOR CTC LEAF** Generally, good demand was noticed in the overall CTC leaf sale. In leaf orthodox, the primary whole leaf grades were generally lower by ₹5 to ₹6. The broken were lower by ₹2 to ₹3 with some withdrawals. The secondaries were also lower by ₹2 to ₹3.

TN mango farmers reap success with scientific, high-density planting

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

M Suresh, a middle-aged farmer from Andipatti in Tamil Nadu's Theni district, was growing cashew on two acres and a traditional mango variety on one acre a couple of years ago. In 2024, he switched to mangoes on all 3 acres. With double the productivity and easy maintenance, he is reaping a happy harvest, thanks to the Coca-Cola Foundation's Project Unnati. "I shifted to mango because I can harvest it at least twice a year," he said in an online interaction with *businessline*. **HARVEST IN NOV-DEC** R Rajendran said that under the project, farmers have ad-

opted ultra-high-density planting (UHDP) and they can get 10-12 tonnes of mangoes per acre a year, against 4-5 tonnes earlier. "We even get to harvest mangoes in (Tamil month) *Karthigai* (November-December) and sell them for ₹30 a kg. UHDP saves labour costs. Maintenance is easy as height of the trees is below 6 ft," he said. For decades, farmers in Theni district were dependent on traditional mango cultivation, characterised by wide spacing, long gestation periods (5-7 years) and low, inconsistent yields. Despite sustained effort, this resulted in unstable incomes and limited scalability. But the project has changed the economics of mango farming. It is helping them to harvest higher yields, double the productivity and earn more. The pro-



R Rajendran of G Usilampatti village, displays the Totapuri variety of mangoes

ject, launched in 2023 in Theni and Dindigul, has now spread to Dharmapuri and Krishnagiri districts. **CHANGING ECONOMICS** G Rajaraman, Subject Matter Specialist, Horticulture at the ICAR Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Theni district, said that under Project Unnati's Mango Initiative, farmers were transitioning to UHDP,

drip irrigation and scientific canopy management, which has changed the fundamentals of mango farming. Coca-Cola took an interest to help meet its demand for mango pulp. "Initially, we started with 2,000 farmers with Coca-Cola giving free grafted seedlings of Neelam and Bangalura (Totapuri) varieties. Farmers were given 50 seedlings of each variety. They were given training on all cultivation practices, particularly to tackle pests and diseases," said Rajaram. Under UDHP, mango seedlings are planted 5 m apart, compared to 10 m for the traditional variety. **SPREADING WINGS** The project saw farmers uproot old trees to plant these UHDP saplings, which resulted in the gestation period

shrinking to 2 years from 6-7 years. "We actually pluck and throw the first flowering, so that from the next stage, there will be higher yield," he said. At least 100 farmers are given training twice a week in every village. This has brought more farmers under the project. "In the first phase, mango cultivation was taken up on 1,500 hectares in Theni and Dindigul districts. In the second phase, 1,800 hectares have been brought under the project in Dharmapuri and Krishnagiri districts," said Rajaram. Since the farms in Dharmapuri and Krishnagiri are rain-fed, the Tamil Nadu government came forward to provide 100 per cent subsidy for drip irrigation. "Project Unnati helped to increase the area under

mango to 55,000 hectares," he said, adding that the yield goes up as high as 15 tonnes per hectare on some farms. **ROAD TO THE PROJECT** M Arun Raj of the Soil Science Department said six subject specialists take care of the project from land preparation to seed to pest management to marketing. "One of the problems with the soil is that the salt content is higher. We guide the farmers to reduce it using organic manure and deoiled neem cake," he said. P Patchaimal, founder of the non-governmental organisation (NGO) Centre for Development and Communication Trust, said that the project had helped in reducing water usage by 40-50 per cent, with drip irrigation coming in handy for the farmers.

QUICKLY.

Coromandel, Samunnati tie up for agri-input access

Chennai: Coromandel International has signed a memorandum of understanding with Samunnati Agri Value Chain Solutions to enable the supply, promotion and distribution of agri-inputs to farmer producer organisations. The MoU aims to strengthen market access by harnessing Samunnati's extensive FPO network and Coromandel's expertise in crop nutrition, crop protection and agri services. **OUR BUREAU**

Rly nod for ₹448 crore electric traction upgrade

New Delhi: In a major boost towards enhancing rail capacity and operational efficiency, the Ministry of Railways has sanctioned the upgradation of the electric traction system on the Mahbubnagar-Secunderabad-Medchal section of the South Central Railway and the Bengaluru-Tumkur section of the South Western Railway. The Bengaluru-Tumkur section is one of the busiest corridors.**ANI**

20 TMC MPs join NDA as Mamata sits with INDIA bloc to protest govt policy

JUMPING SHIP. Voices are being raised against dictatorship and that is good for democracy, says expelled MLA

Poornima Joshi
New Delhi

Embattled Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee joined a meeting of her INDIA partners on Monday when senior party MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar declared that she, along with 19 TMC MPs, will join the BJP-led National Democratic Alliance.

Dastidar said she and other MPs had decided to write to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla declaring their support to the NDA.

However, the Speaker was not in Delhi and his office had not received any resignation letter till the time of going to press.

REBELS MEET CM
What did transpire during the day was that 15 TMC MPs, including Dastidar and Rajya Sabha MP Sukhendu Shekhar Roy, who has already resigned, met West Bengal Chief Minister

Suvendu Adhikari and senior Cabinet Minister Bhupendra Yadav.

Dastidar told reporters that nearly 20 MPs had informed the Speaker of their decision to support the NDA.

In Kolkata, expelled TMC MLA and Leader of the Opposition Ritabrata Banerjee said, “20 MPs have resigned. In fact, more than two-thirds of the MPs have resigned. I cannot say exactly why they did it but voices are being raised against dictatorship and that is good for democracy.”

TMC MP Mohua Moitra was on social media, labelling the faction led by Dastidar as “traitors.”

“All the greedy, self-serving traitors ... can please join the BJP now — resign your seats and contest on BJP ticket. Let’s see what big heroes you are,” she said.

The TMC currently has 28 Lok Sabha MPs, with one vacancy following the death of Basirhat MP Haji Nurul Islam.



UNSETTLED. Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge, party MP Sonia Gandhi and TMC chief Mamata Banerjee during the INDIA bloc meeting in New Delhi on Monday **PTI**

The support of 20 MPs would comfortably cross the two-thirds threshold required for protection under the anti-defection law.

It would simultaneously inflate the NDA's strength from the current 292 seats to 312 if the TMC's rebel faction joins them.

However, it still does not make for 363 seats that the

NDA requires to pass Constitutional amendments in the House.

AGITATION PLAN
Mamata Banerjee, meanwhile, joined 23 members of the INDIA group including Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi, besides Samajwadi Party leader Akhilesh

India expanding nuclear stockpile, eyes targets all over China: SIPRI

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India is estimated to have expanded its nuclear warhead inventory to 190 in 2025 while continuing to develop next-generation nuclear delivery systems, the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI) said in its latest report released on Monday.

The researchers believe that China has 620 warheads and may have as many inter-continental ballistic missiles (ICBMs) as the US and Russia by 2030.

It also said that Pakistan's nuclear warhead number remained stable at 170 last year but the country continued to accumulate fissile material, “suggesting that its nuclear arsenal might expand over the coming decade”.

The institute cautioned that nuclear-armed states were pulling their arms out of storage and integrating them on delivery systems, as the weapons of mass destruction were being leveraged in global politics.

The world's nine nuclear-armed States, including India, are aggressively pivoting back to atomic deterrence. Overall, the world's nuclear powers had an estimated total of 12,187 warheads, with about 9,745 of them being stockpiled for potential use.

The modernisation programme, as per the latest report, of India “is increasingly focused on developing long-range weapons capable of reaching targets throughout China, although planning also continues to be focused on India's long-standing rivalry with Pakistan.”

‘UNUSUALLY SEVERE’
The report of the Stockholm-based think tank drew attention to the May 2025 standoff between India and



Pakistan, describing Operation Sindoor as “an unusually severe military crisis” between the nuclear neighbours.

The report also confirmed that India struck Pakistani air and missile bases during Operation Sindoor “that are likely to have nuclear-related roles”. But, “both sides took steps to avoid escalation,” it said.

According to the report, for the ‘first time’ India and Pakistan indulged in cyber operations during the conflict, demonstrating the changing nature of deterrence and warfare between the rivals. India has maintained its dual status as a global defence heavyweight, retaining its position as the world's fifth-largest military spender and second-largest arms importer between 2021 and 2025, according to the latest yearbook.

DEFENCE BUDGET
New Delhi's defence budget surged to \$92.1 billion in 2025 — an 8.9 per cent increase from the previous year — trailing only the US, China, Russia and Germany, the report observed.

Of the 162 nations importing major weaponry, Ukraine, India, Saudi Arabia, Qatar and Pakistan account for 35 per cent of the global total. India alone accounted for 8.2 per cent of all global arms imports, the report said.

Centre clears ₹50-cr zero solid waste discharge unit for TN leather cluster

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Centre has sanctioned a ₹50 crore Zero Solid Waste Discharge (ZSWD) facility for the leather cluster at Ranipet in Tamil Nadu, a first-of-its-kind initiative that aims to convert solid waste generated during leather processing into industrial-use salt, while reducing the environmental footprint, said a senior Central government official.

The project, expected to be completed by December,

is being implemented as a tripartite venture involving the Tamil Nadu government, industry-led special purpose vehicles (SPVs) and the Centre.

According to Nidhi Kesarwani, Joint Secretary, Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, the facility will complement the extensive effluent treatment infrastructure operating in the State's leather clusters. “This will be one of its kind in the world and will convert the solid waste generated into industrial-use salt, which is economical for



Nidhi Kesarwani (left), Joint Secretary, DPIIT, and Petal Dhillon, Joint Secretary, Commerce Department, at a press conference in Chennai **BUJOY GHOSH**

the industry,” she told newsmen on Monday.

Tamil Nadu has emerged as a key beneficiary of gov-

ernment-backed environmental infrastructure, with eight of the nine Common Effluent Treatment Plants

approved under the Indian Footwear and Leather Development Programme located in the State.

MORE SUSTAINABLE
Kesarwani said the new unit is expected to strengthen sustainable manufacturing practices while enhancing the global competitiveness of leather exports.

The project aligns with the Centre's wider efforts to modernise the leather and footwear sector. Under the Mega Leather Footwear and Accessories Cluster Development scheme, five clusters

have been approved, including one at Panapakkam in Ranipet district with an investment of ₹271 crore. More than 2,000 units across the country have also received support for modernisation under various government programmes.

Petal Dhillon, Joint Secretary, Department of Commerce, said the government's response to the West Asia conflict had focused on easing supply-chain disruptions and containing rising logistics costs rather than providing direct financial compensation.

Zen Tech develops AI-powered anti-drone system

Dalip Singh
Hyderabad

Zen Technologies Ltd is developing a comprehensive anti-drone system designed especially to neutralise hostile swarm unmanned platforms using a combined “soft kill” and “hard kill” grid, CMD Ashok Atluri said.

While Zen has non-kinetic soft kill systems, it is now pivoting towards upgraded integrated, automated weapon systems — a hard kill shift Atluri admits poses an engineering challenge.

The company has so far supplied to the armed forces Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems (C-UAS) of different capabilities. These include an anti-drone system with hard-kill capability, which integrates legacy L-70 air defence guns to detect target data from sensors and automatically lead the barrel to track and shoot down hostile drones. Likewise, it has supplied an anti-drone sys-



tem soft-kill framework to jam communication networks and navigation links to bring down hostile drones.

Their systems were also deployed during Operation Sindoor.

“We want to expose soldiers as little as possible by offering completely AI-driven automated weapon systems,” Atluri said during an interaction at his Hyderabad facility.

Referring to the development cycle, the Zen CMD stated that multiple simula-

Their systems were also deployed during Operation Sindoor

tions of actual scenarios are going on to arrive at solutions for shooting down drones in varied numbers.

“We are examining what kind of remote controlled weapon systems would be required for this comprehensive model. We will eventually do the trials to know the kill ratio. By the end of this year, we should be in a position to carry out testing at our Hyderabad facility,” he stated.

DOUBLE WHAMMY
On the first anniversary of Operation Sindoor, the company launched India's first fully integrated, AI-powered anti-drone system at the North Tech Symposium in Prayag. Featuring a unified soft-kill and hard-kill architecture, this modern defence solution counters the exact

low-cost drone swarms currently overwhelming traditional air defences in global conflicts.

He stated that Zen Technologies is developing aircraft simulators for the IAF after meeting the requirements of the Indian Army with different sets for firing training of small arms and artillery guns, and for driving trucks and tanks, apart from others for the Navy.

Through six subsidiaries, it is also developing smart bombs like air bursts and loitering munitions, engines for long-endurance UAVs, and is using automation and robotics to fulfil military objectives.

AERIAL VEHICLES
Vector Technics, a subsidiary which offers indigenous DC propulsion systems for different weight classes and mission types of drones and has clients like Tata Advanced Systems Ltd (TASL) and Bharat Forge, is now moving towards manufac-

turing internal combustion fuel-powered engines for aerial vehicles.

The initiative is a strategic move to ensure readiness in indigenous propulsion technology, focusing on the power requirements of long-endurance drones.

“Drones are developing as fast as AI. Our formula is to fail fast to get engines fast,” remarked Vector Technics' CEO Prudhvi Raj Pakalapati at his shopfloor on the outskirts of the capital city, surrounded by youngsters immersed in front of screens and tools and machinery to produce motors for drones.

Karna Raj, Co-founder and Chief Technology Officer (CTO) of the start-up, said they would be in a position to go for trials of the engine propulsion system, having endurance for a five-to-eight-hour long mission, in the second quarter of 2027.

(The writer was invited by Zen Technologies Ltd to witness the development of its military platforms)

CBI files FIR in ₹397 crore TN transformer purchase scam

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The CBI has registered an FIR in an alleged ₹397-crore scam case related to the procurement of transformers in Tamil Nadu during V Senthil Balaji's tenure as the State's Electricity Minister between 2021 and 2023, officials said Monday.

The agency has registered the case against the then officials of the Tender Inviting Authority and Tender Scrutiny Committee of Tangedco, Chennai, other public servants, private persons, and contractors under IPC sections related to criminal conspiracy and cheating, as well as the provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act.

The FIR has alleged corruption in tenders floated for the supply of distribution transformers of a range of specifications.

Eight workers killed in Vizag steel plant mishap

Press Trust of India
Visakhapatnam

At least eight workers of the Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Ltd (Vizag steel plant) were killed and six injured here on Monday after molten iron spilt on them, officials said.

Reacting to the mishap, Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed sadness and extended *ex gratia* to the kin of the deceased and injured workers.

“Saddened by the mishap at the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant. Condolences to those who have lost their loved ones. Praying that the injured recover at the earliest,” PM Modi said in a post on X.

An *ex gratia* of ₹2 lakh from the Prime Minister National Relief Fund would be given to the next of kin of each deceased, he said, adding that the injured would be given ₹50,000.

Likewise, Chief Minister

N Chandrababu Naidu said on X, “I am distressed to learn that several workers have lost their lives in this accident. I have spoken to the concerned officials and directed them to undertake relief measures in coordination with all government departments.”

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thehindu**businessline.**

Midhani targets rare earth independence with next-gen alloys, infrastructure push

bl.interview

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

Aligning with the government's initiative on rare earth independence, the sole State-owned Mishra Dhatu Nigam Ltd (Midhani), is focusing on indigenous development of advanced alloys and strategic materials and expanding and modernising manufacturing capacities and technology.

Midhani CMD SVS Narayana Murthy says that over the next decade, the PSU expects significant advancements, among others, in next-generation superalloys, advanced titanium alloys and high temperature aerospace materials.

Edited excerpts:

India is pushing defence indigenisation in

critical materials. What is the roadmap to localise them?

Our roadmap focuses on three key pillars — indigenous development of advanced alloys and strategic materials, the expansion of manufacturing capacities and technology infrastructure, and strengthening domestic supply chains for critical raw materials. We have been supplying materials for aero systems for satellites like PSLV and GSLV, and missiles including Agni and Akash. We work closely with DRDO, ISRO, HAL, BDL, DPSUs, academic institutions and private industry to develop next-generation materials for defence, aerospace, space, energy and strategic sectors to minimise imports.

Aero-engine metallurgy is considered one of the toughest technologies globally. How close is

Midhani maintains a balanced order portfolio with defence, aerospace, space, and atomic energy continuing to be the primary contributors

SVS NARAYANA MURTY
CMD, Midhani

Midhani to becoming a global supplier of engine-grade superalloys?

Aero-engine metallurgy represents one of the most sophisticated domains of materials science.

Engine materials must withstand temperatures exceeding 1,000°C while maintaining exceptional strength, creep resistance, fatigue life and reliability.

With increasing global demand for reliable suppliers



and ongoing diversification of aerospace supply chains, Midhani is well-positioned to emerge as an important global supplier of engine-grade materials.

Which regions and industries are driving the export growth?

Midhani is exporting to more than 20 countries. Its export growth is being driven by increasing demand from aerospace, defence, energy, engineering and industrial

sectors across North America, Europe, West Asia and the Asia-Pacific. The global search for reliable suppliers of specialty materials has created significant opportunities for us.

We have generated around 8-10 per cent revenue from exports in FY25, about ₹94 crore. In FY26, it was ₹84 crore since the company avoided orders in some cases due to the stiff supply chain constraints for master alloys.

Which rare metals and advanced alloys represent the biggest future opportunity for Midhani?

Major opportunities exist in advanced titanium alloys, nickel-based superalloys, cobalt-based alloys, refractory alloys, aerospace propulsion materials, strategic defence materials and advanced energy-sector alloys.

What proportion comes from defence, aerospace, space and commercial sectors?

Midhani maintains a balanced order portfolio with defence, aerospace, space

KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice

Tender No : KWA/HO/SP-02/2026-27/TR4-A. EMPANELMENT OF MANUFACTURERS OF TRANSFORMERS IN WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE PROJECTS OF KERALA WATER AUTHORITY. EMD : Rs. 5000/-, Tender fee : Rs. 2500/-, Last Date for submitting Tender : 19-06-2026 03:00:pm, Phone : 8547638078, Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in, www.etenders.kerala.gov.in

Chief Engineer (HRD & GL)
Jalabhavan, Thiruvananthapuram

ERNAKULAM REGIONAL CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD.

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No. EUP/PUR/32/COMPL/2026-27/2439 06.06.2026

Title	Tender Id	Pre-bid Meeting	Bid Submission End Date
Supply of wide mouth non stick cooking pot with glass lid and handle (Uruli).	2026_KCMFME854710_1	12.06.2026 11.00 AM	22.06.2026 01.00 PM

For More details: Tel: 0484 - 2541193 <http://etenders.kerala.gov.in> (Sd/-) Managing Director

QUICKLY.

Lupin to launch fixed dose respiratory drug in Spain



Mumbai: Lupin Limited is partnering with Spanish pharma company Laboratorios ERN SA to launch its fixed dose combination Luforbec (beclometasone/formoterol) in Spain. The drug, administered via inhaler, is used to treat adult asthma and chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. **OUR BUREAU**

SpiceJet to induct 3 Airbus A320 aircraft



New Delhi: To cater to growing passenger demand, SpiceJet said that it will induct three Airbus A320 aircraft in July on a damp lease basis. On Monday, the airline said it has finalised a lease agreement to induct these aircraft. The airline currently has 21 aircraft in its fleet. SpiceJet also said it has successfully ungrounded and returned a Boeing 737 MAX aircraft to service. The aircraft, SpiceJet said, had already commenced commercial operations. **OUR BUREAU**

Star Air on track to add two Embraer E190 aircraft to fleet

Aneesh Phadnis

Star Air is on track to induct two Embraer E190 aircraft to serve high-demand routes, the airline’s Chief Executive Officer Simran Singh Tiwana said.

Currently, Star Air operates eight Embraer E175 aircraft that have 76-88 seats. The E190s will have 108 seats, and thus will be the largest in its fleet. While industry sources said that Star Air had temporarily deferred the aircraft induction due to rising fuel costs, Singh said the plan was on schedule.

EXPANSION STRATEGY “The induction timelines remain aligned with our planned fleet expansion strategy and preparations for the aircraft entry into service are progressing as scheduled,” he said.

RBI announces swap window for ECBs, FCNR (B) deposits

BUFFER STAYS. Measures to extend hedging support, liquidity management till Jan 2027

Our Bureau

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Monday unveiled two significant liquidity management measures aimed at stabilising foreign currency inflows and supporting institutions accessing overseas funds.

The RBI introduced a US dollar-rupee forex swap facility for external commercial borrowings (ECBs) and a parallel scheme for fresh FCNR (B) deposits, making a proactive stance in managing external sector risks.

The ECB swap facility is targeted at public sector undertakings (PSUs) under government ownership or established under central or state legislation, as well as authorised dealer category 1 banks raising overseas foreign currency borrowings (OFCBs).

Eligible borrowings must carry a minimum maturity of three years.

The facility will remain open until January 15, 2027, covering drawdowns and flows received up to December 31, 2026.

Importantly, the scheme also extends to undrawn portions of existing ECBs, though borrowings with embedded options or those raised for refinancing are ex-



PSU FOCUSED. The ECB swap facility is targeted at public sector undertakings under government ownership

cluded. Under this arrangement, banks can sell US dollars to RBI and repurchase them at the end of the swap period at a fixed premium of 1.5 per cent per annum, compounded semi annually.

REPAYMENT PLAN

The tenor is capped at five years, aligned to repayment schedules, and operations will be conducted daily.

The oversight will rest with the RBI’s Financial Markets Operations Department (FMOD), ensuring compliance with FEMA regulations and the master direction on risk management.

RBI has also simultaneously opened a swap window for fresh FCNR (B) deposits, effective immediately and available until October 16, 2026.

The scheme applies to deposits mobilised between June 8 and September 30, 2026, with a minimum tenor of three years and a maximum of five years.

While deposits can be raised in any freely convertible currency, the swap facility with RBI is restricted to US dollars.

Banks must convert non-dollar deposits into equivalent US dollar amounts at prevailing market rates, maintaining consistent conversion policies and audit trails.

FRESH DEPOSITS

The swap operates at par, with both legs of the transaction undertaken at the FBIL (Financial Benchmark India Private Limited) reference rate. Each bank can avail of

the facility once a week, capped at the equivalent of fresh deposits mobilised during the preceding weeks.

Deposits carry a one-year lock in, though premature withdrawals may be permitted thereafter.

RBI has also exempted banks from maintaining of CRR and SLR on fresh FCNR (B) deposits mobilised till September 30, 2026.

HEDGE COST

Gaura Sengupta, Chief Economist, IDFC First Bank, said, “The FCNR (B) window is expected to draw \$40 billion of inflows. RBI will absorb the entire hedge cost which is more than 3 per cent. This enables the scheme to be attractive for both banks and NRI, despite narrow interest rate differentials compared to 2013.”

Anshul Chandok, Head Treasury, RBL Bank, said, “There is no currency risk in the current FCNR (B) window. With RBI opening the gates for FPI flows, the opportunity is highly lucrative, especially as rates are expected to settle in the 6-7 per cent range over the next few days.”

By extending support to PSUs, banks, and deposit mobilisation, RBI measures are expected to bolster forex liquidity, hedging risks, and ensuring orderly inflows.

AI grounds 3 A320s after damage caused by storm at Delhi airport

Rohit Vaid

New Delhi

Tata Group-led Air India has grounded three of its Airbus A320 aircraft after they were damaged at Delhi airport during severe weather conditions, sources told *businessline*.

While one of the aircraft sustained serious damage, two others are also affected with varying impact, requiring time for necessary rectification.

The incident involved ground handling equipment and foreign object debris striking parked aircraft at Terminal 2 of the IGI Airport during adverse weather conditions on June 7.

AIRCRAFT DAMAGES

Accordingly, the severely-damaged A320 may have to be grounded for an estimated three weeks for repairs. The other two aircraft will also need time to become serviceable.



Speaking to *businessline*, industry sources said the second A320 aircraft is undergoing damage assessment, while the third may be cleared to resume operations within a shorter period of time.

The development comes as the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has launched an investigation into the incident.

According to sources, the airline currently has adequate capacity to cater to passenger demand and does not expect any operational disruption arising from the incident.

However, they pointed out

the airline would need to be compensated for the damage sustained by the affected aircraft once the probe establishes the reason for this incident.

On its part, Air India declined to comment, citing the ongoing investigation.

As per a DGCA statement, strong winds experienced during the weather event caused two pieces of ground equipment positioned at an adjacent stand and nearby areas to shift from their designated locations.

The equipment subsequently struck two separate Airbus A320 aircraft at multiple locations, resulting in structural damage.

In addition, the right sliding window of a third aircraft was damaged after being struck by flying debris.

The aviation regulator said all three aircraft were initially grounded from commercial service to undergo detailed technical inspections and maintenance checks.

VISUALLY.

Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic KS Gunasekar

The biggest World Cup yet

The 2026 FIFA World Cup, beginning on June 11, will be the largest tournament in football history. Hosted by the United States, Canada and Mexico, it will feature 48 teams, 104 matches, and an expected 6.5 million spectators. Data from BofA Global Research’s ‘The Beautiful Game: World Cup 2026 Guide’ show the tournament could generate \$40.9 billion in economic impact and support 8,24,000 jobs, highlighting how the World Cup has become a major global economic and technological phenomenon

World Cup 2026 will combine football with AI, sensors, robotics and real-time technology	
New feature	What it means
Sensor-equipped match ball	Sensor tracks the ball 500 times per second and helps VAR decisions
AI-enabled 3D player avatars	Players are scanned to create 3D models for more accurate offside calls
Robot dogs	Robotic security units will help police monitor stadium areas
Advanced semi-automated offside technology	Officials receive instant audio alerts for offside as small as 10 cm

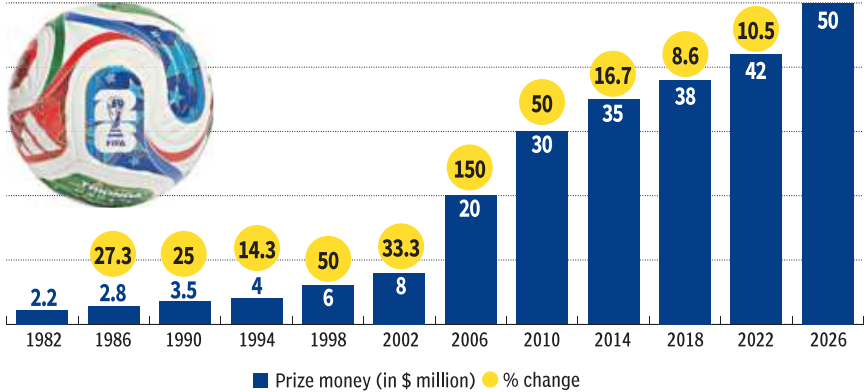


FIFA

Teams	Matches
48	104
Host nations US, Canada, Mexico	
Expected attendance 6.5 m	
Expected GDP impact \$40.9 b	
Jobs supported 8,24,000	

2026 World Cup winner prize money up nearly 20% from 2022

Prize money awarded to winning teams of the FIFA World Cup



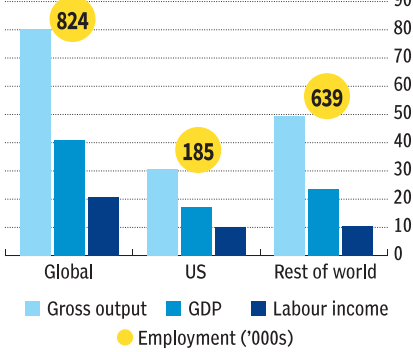
Top 10 highest-valued qualified teams of 2026 World Cup

(in \$ million)



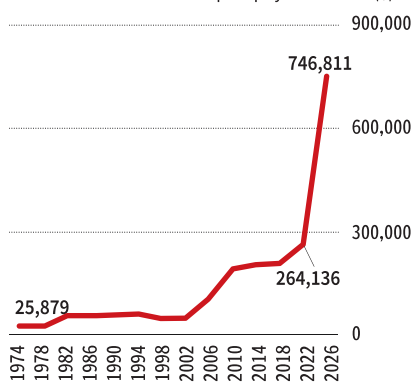
World Cup 2026 estimated to help drive up to \$41b in global GDP

Estimated impact of FIFA World Cup 2026 on the World, US, RoW



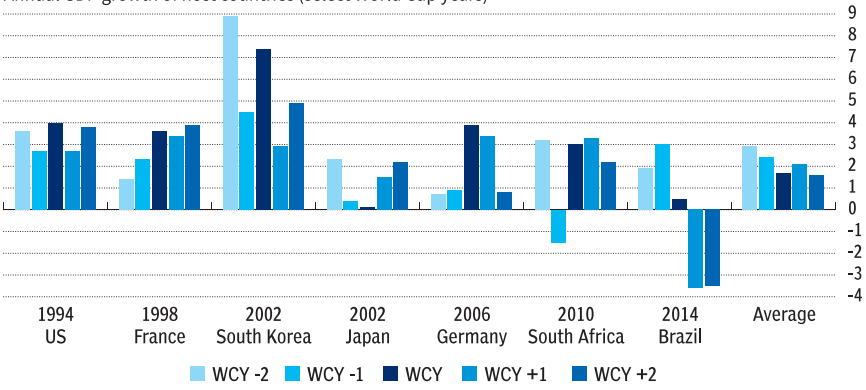
The gold value of the World Cup trophy is c.\$747,000

Gold value of the World Cup trophy since 1974 (\$)



0.4pp increase in GDP growth 1 year after World Cup

Annual GDP growth of host countries (select World Cup years)



Source: The Beautiful Game: World Cup 2026 Guide by BofA Global Research

India expresses ‘utmost concern’ over escalation in W. Asia conflict

Amiti Sen

New Delhi

Expressing ‘utmost concern’ over the dangerous escalation of hostilities in West Asia, India on Monday warned that the conflict is inflicting immense human suffering while dealing a ‘debilitating impact’ to the global economy and critical energy supplies.

In a statement, New Delhi called on all parties to de-escalate tensions, ensure that civilians are not harmed and conclude ongoing negotiations for a diplomatic solution. “India deeply regrets the renewed attacks in West Asia. These developments are a matter of utmost concern to the international community,” the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said.

IMMENSE SUFFERING

Israel carried out air strikes in western and central Iran after Iran fired missiles at northern Israel.

The statement highlighted that the conflict was resulting in immense human suffering and was also hurting global economy.



TENSIONS ESCALATE. Smoke billows following Israeli strikes in southern Lebanon **REUTERS**

“This conflict has now lasted over 100 days and has already caused immense human suffering. It has also had a debilitating impact on the global economy and energy supplies,” it said.

DIPLOMATIC SOLUTION

India also called for de-escalation of tensions. “We call on all parties to immediately de-escalate tensions, ensure that civilians are not harmed and conclude ongoing negotiations for a diplomatic solution so that peace and stability can return to the region,” it said.

US President Donald

Trump, too, asked Israel and Iran to “immediately stop shooting”.

Iran initiated, what it warned, will be “a full week of continuous strikes” against Israel. This followed Israeli air strikes on Hezbollah targets in southern Beirut on Sunday, which the Israeli military defended as a necessary response to previous Hezbollah rocket fire.

However, later on Monday, Iran declared an end to its military operations against Israel, warning that Israel’s further attacks on Lebanon could lead to an escalation.

‘India, US trade deal only after Section 301 probe is concluded’

Amiti Sen

New Delhi

India and the US can conclude the first phase of the bilateral trade agreement (BTA) only after the ongoing Section 301 investigations by the US Trade Representative against India are concluded making the tariff situation clear, an official said on Monday.

New Delhi will insist on a commitment from the US that there would be no additional tariffs on Indian goods after the trade deal was finalised, the official added.

“If the US wants us to pay any additional tax... They have to finish the Section 301 process before that,” the official said. India also wants that any trade pact with the US should place it at an advantageous position compared to its competitors such as Bangladesh, Vietnam, Indonesia and Cambodia.

STEEP TARIFFS

Going by the February 6 framework deal announced by the two countries, which the US largely wants to be followed, Washington would



India is of the opinion that any trade pact with the US should place it at an advantageous position compared to its competitors

impose steep tariffs of 18 per cent (over and above regular MFN tariffs) on Indian goods, while India would eliminate or slash import duties on all industrial goods and a wide range of farm goods.

However, with the US Supreme Court subsequently invalidating the 25 per cent US reciprocal tariffs, Indian goods are facing just 10 per cent temporary global tariffs that would lapse on July 24.

India now is being investigated for trade violations under two Section 301 (one on forced labour and the other on excess capacities), by the USTR, and is already facing the threat of 12.5 per cent tariffs under one while awaiting the recommendations on the second.

Oil tanker carrying 24 Indians catches fire near Oman; all crew safe

Press Trust of India

New Delhi

A fire was reported aboard an oil tanker carrying 24 Indian seafarers off the coast of Oman on Monday, as Israel and Iran exchanged fresh attacks in their first major escalation since the ceasefire.

The Madagascar-flagged *MT Marivex* reported a fire around 1.30 pm IST, Opesh Kumar Sharma, a director in the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, said at a news briefing.

Sharma declined to comment on the cause of the fire but said the vessel was carrying 24 Indian crew members.

The tanker was empty and located well outside the Strait of Hormuz, which has been affected by regional tensions, he said.

“This is the preliminary information which we have received... as per available information, all Indian seafarers are safe,” Sharma said.

“We are coordinating with the Ministry of External Affairs, our missions abroad, Indian Navy, Ministry of De-

The tanker, sailing towards Duqm port, was empty and located well outside the Strait of Hormuz

fence, to ensure their safety.” Ship-tracking data showed the vessel at anchor south of Muscat.

DISTRESS CALL

The tanker issued a distress call after reportedly coming under attack while sailing toward the Omani port of Duqm, according to preliminary reports. “The Mission is seized of an incident involving a ship with Indian sailors onboard. We are in touch with the Omani authorities for their rescue and safety,” the Embassy of India in Muscat said in a post on X.

“We are thankful to the Omani authorities for their swift response and rescue of all the 24 crew members of Indian nationality onboard *MT Marivex* and ensuring their safety,” it said.

